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ECONOMIC & SOCIAL
RESEARCH INSTITUTE

Social transfers utilisation among migrants and Irish-born in Ireland

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An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
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Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration



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ABBREVIATIONS

ARP	Accommodation Recognition Payment
BoTPs	Beneficiaries of Temporary Protection
CSO	Central Statistics Office
DEA	Daily Expenses Allowance
EU-SILC	European Union Statistics on Income and Living Conditions
HRC	Habitual residence condition
ILO	International Labour Organization
IPAS	International Protection Accommodation Services
MS	Member States
NCMT	Non-contributory means-tested
PP	Percentage points
SILC	Survey on Income and Living Conditions
USD	Unemployment, sickness and disability benefits

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Debates about the impacts of immigration on host countries have been ongoing for many years, covering a broad range of social and economic issues. From an economic perspective, a recurring question is whether immigration reduces the wages and employment opportunities of the native-born. Another strand of the debate relates to the fiscal impact of immigration. In this report, we focus on a specific dimension of the fiscal impact and assess whether immigrants in Ireland are more or less likely to be in receipt of social welfare payments compared to the native-born.

We begin the analysis by looking at the labour market outcomes of immigrants between 2014 and 2024. We show that immigrants have generally had higher employment rates than the native-born and higher unemployment rates too. These two contrasting outcomes are possible because immigrants have also tended to have higher rates of labour force participation (i.e. a lower share of inactive population within the working-age population).

Turning to the examination of welfare receipt across immigrants and natives, we use the Central Statistics Office (CSO) Survey on Income and Living Conditions (SILC) from 2014 to 2024 and include all people aged 15 to 65 regardless of whether they have an income. It should be noted here that in order to access some social welfare payments in Ireland, applicants must pass a ‘habitually resident condition’, through which people’s connection to Ireland is determined.

Overall, the findings in the report show that there is no general pattern of immigrants being more likely to be in receipt of welfare compared to the native-born. We initially present a descriptive analysis looking at rates of welfare receipt based on simple proportions, without adjusting for socio-economic characteristics for both immigrants and natives. Focusing on unemployment, sickness/disability and family/children-related welfare payments, in 2024, 56 per cent of the Irish-born received at least one of these payments compared to 61 per cent of immigrants, and the difference is statistically significant. For both, the high rates of receipt were driven by family payments, including the universal child benefit, and the rate of receipt was higher for immigrants – 58 vs. 47 per cent. Looking at other payments (e.g. unemployment-related payments), we see either no difference between immigrants and the native-born, or lower rates of receipt among immigrants.

A more complicated picture emerges when we separate immigrants by regions of birth. Looking at unemployment welfare payments, the rate of receipt for the Irish-born pooled across 2014 to 2024 was 16 per cent. The rates of receipt are lower for immigrants from EU West (13 per cent) and Asia (12 per cent) but higher for EU East (21 per cent) and Africa (21 per cent).

A key question in the report is whether any differences in welfare receipt across immigrants and natives change in magnitude or direction¹ once we use regression analysis to control for characteristics that are related to welfare receipt. The complicated picture continues with different patterns across different groups of immigrants. Looking at unemployment, sickness and disability payments combined, the regression analysis shows that immigrants from the UK and the EU East have higher rates of receipt but immigrants from the EU West have lower rates. No differences are found when comparing the native-born to immigrants from Asia and Africa.

As there are important differences in the criteria for receipt of contributory and non-contributory payments, we next distinguish between these two types of payments. Contributory payments refer to payments which can only be accessed when the required social insurance payments have been made. Such payments are not means-tested. By contrast, non-contributory payments do not require prior histories of social insurance payments. Once again, a mixed picture emerges. For contributory-based payments with no means testing, and focusing on unemployment, sickness and disability payments, the regression analysis shows higher rates of receipt for immigrants from the EU East and lower rates for those from the EU West, Asia and Africa. For non-contributory payments in respect of unemployment, sickness and disability, the regression analysis shows higher rates of receipt for immigrants from the EU East and Africa.

While the analysis shows a mixed picture across immigrant groups and over time, immigrants from the EU East are generally found to have higher rates of receipt compared to the native-born. In the case of some payments, the adjusted differential is minimal (only 2 percentage points for non-contributory payments in respect of unemployment, sickness and disability). And the difference disappears when we focus on unemployment payments to people who were unemployed at the time of the survey. Nonetheless, the findings of higher rates of receipt for the EU East contrast with the analysis of Barrett et al. (2013) where much lower rates were found (in comparison to the Irish-born). This turnaround in the relative pattern of welfare receipt across immigrants from the EU East and the native-born is striking, and similar changes over time across other groups are not as evident. This prompted us to look at the demographical characteristics of immigrants from the EU East over time, and we see a group that is now older, with more females and more children.

The large inflow of Ukrainian immigrants since the outbreak of war in 2022 is not well captured in the SILC data but, given the scale of the inflow, we were eager to draw on other data sources to present some information on welfare receipt among Ukrainians in Ireland since 2022. The data available on Ukrainian arrivals since 2022 are more limited than those used in the analysis just described. However, those

¹ i.e. do the Irish-born receive more or less than the other groups.

data suggest that the proportion of Ukrainians of working age who were in receipt of working age supports fell from over 70 per cent in mid-2022 to just over 40 per cent in mid-2025. Similarly, the number of Ukrainians on housing supports rose through early 2024 but have declined continuously since.

In conclusion, this report does not find any general trend that immigrants are more likely than the native-born to receive welfare payments. People born in the EU West and Asia are found to be generally less likely than the native-born to receive such payments, while those born in the EU East are found to receive more in specific cases, although such differences disappear when focusing on the unemployed population (i.e. those most likely to take up such payments). In the case of immigrants from Africa, although they show higher rates of receipt for non-contributory payments, they show lower rates for contributory payments. This mixed pattern suggests that any efforts to assist immigrants in exiting welfare should continue to be the same as the efforts directed at the native-born whereby the specific circumstances of individuals should be addressed to the greatest possible extent.

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

Immigration has always been a controversial issue, with suggestions that immigrants place burdens on the populations of receiving countries in terms of taking jobs, depressing wages and occupying limited housing supply. In recent times, there appears to have been a marked increase, both in Ireland and elsewhere, in negative views of immigration based in part on the idea that immigrants draw heavily on aspects of the modern welfare state such as benefit payments, healthcare and other social supports.

As a result, a large literature has developed which seeks to quantify the effects of immigration on variables such as wages and employment levels of natives. There has also been a growing interest in the analysis of the fiscal impact of immigration. This is usually done by estimating the taxes paid by immigrants and the public expenditures attributed to them, in order to assess their net contributions.

This report is closely related to this literature, but the focus is specific. Our primary aim is to assess the extent to which immigrants in Ireland are in receipt of social welfare payments and how their rates of receipt compare to those of native-born. We do this in two ways using the Irish Survey on Income and Living Conditions (SILC) data covering the years from 2014 to 2024. First, we look at the proportions of immigrants and natives who are in receipt of payments, looking across various immigrant groups and various types of payments. Second, recognising that immigrants and natives differ in terms of socio-economic characteristics which influence the likelihood of welfare receipt, we use regression analysis to adjust the raw data and explore if immigrants and natives differ in terms of welfare receipt once we control for these other factors. This analysis updates the work carried out by Barrett et al. (2013). We do not attempt to undertake a full assessment of the fiscal impact of immigration but our analysis clearly informs this question, especially when we consider the proportion of immigrants who receive welfare payments. In addition, the analysis which produces adjusted estimates of welfare receipt among immigrants helps to uncover whether immigrants are more welfare-prone compared to natives with the same socio-economic characteristics.

The report is structured as follows: in the next chapter, we review the literature that has considered this question of welfare receipt among immigrants both in Ireland and elsewhere. We also look at the policy context, in particular the administrative approach to determining welfare eligibility among immigrants. Recognising the importance of labour market outcomes for determining welfare receipt, in Chapter 3 we look at the labour market experiences of immigrants compared to the native-born over the period 2014 to 2024. In Chapter 4, we

describe the Irish SILC data which is used in our analysis and present the results of that analysis. The large inflow of Ukrainian immigrants since the outbreak of war in 2022 is not well-captured in the SILC data. We thus draw on other data sources in Chapter 5, to present some information on welfare receipt among Ukrainians in Ireland since 2022. In Chapter 6, we summarise and offer some concluding comments.

CHAPTER 2

Literature and policy context

A number of papers on immigrants and welfare payments have been published in the economics literature in the last quarter century and, to an extent, many were motivated by Borjas (1999). The topic of that paper was the so-called welfare-magnet hypothesis – whether immigrants are attracted to countries with more generous welfare payments and looser eligibility criteria. Borjas (1999) used variation in welfare generosity across the states in the US to explore whether immigrants tended to move to more generous states. He found evidence in support of the welfare magnet hypothesis, but subsequent studies have been less definitive. In a useful summary of the literature, Giulietti (2014) concludes that the dominant factors in migration destination decisions are employment, wages, geographic proximity and the presence of social networks. Giulietti also notes that where immigrants are found to have higher rates of welfare receipt than natives, the difference is typically explained by differences in the socio-economic characteristics across the two groups.

The earliest explorations of welfare receipt by immigrants compared to natives in Ireland were carried by Barrett and McCarthy (2007 and 2008). In both papers, immigrants were found to be less likely to receive benefits, but important differences were found across immigrant groups; immigrants from non-English-speaking countries were substantially less likely to be in receipt whereas no differences were evident across natives and immigrants from English-speaking countries. These papers used data from 2004 and 2005 respectively and so did not capture the large inflows into Ireland after the EU expansion in 2004 and later. For this reason, Barrett et al. (2013) updates the previous analysis.

As noted in the introduction, this paper updates the work by Barrett et al. (2013), so it is useful to consider their approach and results. Using the European Union Statistics on Income and Living Conditions (EU-SILC) from 2008, they examined the extent to which immigrants were in receipt of welfare compared to natives. Initially, they looked at the raw (unadjusted) statistics and showed that there was no statistically significant difference between rates of receipt when all immigrants were compared to all natives. However, Barrett et al. (2013) went on to look at different immigrant groups and different payments and at this point, differences could be seen. For example, immigrants were less likely to be in receipt of unemployment benefits, and this was especially true for immigrants from the countries that had joined the EU in 2004 and for immigrants with non-English-speaking backgrounds.

Rather than just looking at the raw data, Barrett et al. (2013) were interested in assessing whether immigrants were more or less likely to be in receipt of welfare when accounting for characteristics which contribute to the likelihood of being in receipt. For example, more highly educated people are less likely to be on welfare so if it was the case that immigrants had lower rates of receipt, a question would arise as to whether this was because of their levels of education or their immigrant status.

In order to answer this question, Barrett et al. (2013) estimated probit models where the dependent variable was a dummy variable indicating relative receipt or not. Immigrant status was entered as a control (with native-born being the omitted category) along with variables such as gender, education, years of work and marital status. Across all benefits, results showed that immigrants from the accession countries were 18.7 per cent less likely to be in receipt of benefits compared to natives. Looking specifically at unemployment and disability payment combined, this group of immigrants were found to be 11.5 per cent less likely to be in receipt of these payments.

Reflecting on these findings of lower rates of welfare receipt among the accession country immigrants, Barrett et al. (2013) concluded that the application of the habitually resident condition was the likely reason.

The research undertaken by Barrett et al. (2013) was part of a wider project on welfare receipt by immigrants across a selection of European countries, so we can briefly consider some of the other contributions. Drinkwater and Robinson (2013) conducted the same type of analysis for the UK, using data from the UK Labour Force Surveys from 2004 to 2009. As with Barrett et al. (2013), no single immigrant effect is found but instead there was a mix of results depending on benefit type and country of origin of the immigrants. As with the study on Ireland, immigrants from the EU's accession states were generally found to have lower rates of receipt, including for unemployment and sickness/disability payments. However, this same group were found to be more likely to be in receipt of housing/council tax benefits.

Rodríguez-Planas (2013) used the Spanish Labour Force Surveys of 1999 to 2009 to explore the same issues for Spain. In general, immigrants are found to be less likely to be in receipt of welfare when probit models are estimated and controls added to take account of welfare-determining characteristics. But as was the case for the Irish and UK studies, important differences were found across immigrant groups. Rodríguez-Planas draws particular attention to differences according to length of time spent in Spain. The overall finding of lower rates of receipt is driven by recently arrived immigrants; for immigrants who had been in Spain for five years or more, higher rates of receipt of unemployment-related payments were found.

Pellizzari (2013) considers the Italian case. He uses administrative data rather than survey-based data and these data only allowed him to consider the question of applications for benefits as opposed to actual receipt. His results showed higher

rates of receipt among immigrants but also that immigrant/native differences fall considerably when controls are added for the socio-economic characteristics that typically influence welfare receipt.

A more recent example of these explorations is Conte and Mazza (2019). In this study, the authors looked at relative rates of welfare receipt by immigrants across 20 host countries in the EU. They looked exclusively at immigrants from outside the EU and their focus was on differences in relative receipt of contributory and non-contributory payments. They used data from the EU-SILC from the years 2014 to 2016 and looked at both the raw differentials in receipt and differentials adjusting for welfare-related socio-economic characteristics.

Across most countries, non-EU immigrants are less likely to be in receipt of contributory payments. The situation reverses when non-contributory payments are considered, with many countries showing higher rates among immigrants. Generally, the gaps diminish significantly when other factors are entered as controls in the probit regressions. This leads the authors to emphasise the role of these other factors in determining receipt rates among immigrants, rather than immigrant status alone.

Other studies have also considered the question of welfare receipt among immigrants but with a different emphasis. When studies explore the broader issue of the fiscal impact of immigrants, their interest is in the unadjusted differentials in rates of receipt as these are what contribute to fiscal impacts. The more nuanced question of how unadjusted differentials might change when controlling for other factors is less relevant in this strand of the literature.

One example of these studies is van de Beek et al. (2023). Their goal was to estimate the fiscal impact of immigration in the Netherlands and so involved the estimation of taxes contributed and the apportioning of public expenditure across immigrants and natives. In the case of welfare benefits, they provide detailed information on rates of receipt across immigrants from different countries and regions and by age. The highest rates of receipt are found for immigrants from the Horn of Africa and Sudan followed by immigrants collectively from Iran, Iraq, Afghanistan and Syria. The lowest rates of receipt are found for Japan and Oceania.

Another example of the fiscal impact literature is OECD (2021). Like van de Beek et al. (2023), the methodological challenge is to estimate taxes paid by immigrants and to apportion expenditures. While details of the methods are given, less is provided on the findings regarding immigrant welfare receipt.

From a policy perspective, the results above do not point to a generalised finding of excess demands on welfare systems by immigrants. Where evidence of higher rates of receipt have emerged, this is typically related to the characteristics of the immigrant groups whereby they are disadvantaged in the labour market and so more reliant on benefits. Policy discussions in this literature tend to focus on

strategies to integrate immigrants whereby any reliance on welfare is reduced. However, this is an area where the political imperative to be seen to address welfare receipt among immigrants often leads to policies to directly limit immigrant access to welfare.

Before proceeding to the analysis of immigrant welfare receipt, it is important to set out how eligibility for welfare payments is determined. For contributory payments such as unemployment benefits, eligibility is based on a record of social insurance contributions and this does not differ across natives and immigrants, once immigrants are legally present. Contributory unemployment benefits are paid for a limited period between six and nine months, depending on the claimant's PRSI contribution record before transitioning to non-contributory benefit. Therefore, differences in benefit take-up may reflect variations in people's work histories and the length of their unemployment. But for non-contributory benefits, such as the universal child benefit payment, applicants must pass the 'habitual residence condition' (HRC).

The origin of the HRC starts around 2004, when the EU admitted eight new Member States (MS). Ireland was one of the few existing members to allow full and immediate access to its labour market to the citizens of the new MS. Such a liberal approach led to concerns about large numbers of new arrivals and possible demands on the social welfare system. In order to address these concerns, the government introduced a requirement for people (both Irish nationals and others) to have been resident in Ireland (or the UK) for two years prior to a welfare claim in order to be eligible. Over time, the HRC was developed and decisions on whether the condition is met by an individual is now based on the following five criteria:

1. Length and continuity of residence in Ireland
2. Length and purpose of any absence from Ireland
3. Nature and pattern of employment
4. Main centre of interest
5. Future intentions to live in Ireland as it appears from the evidence

Decisions are made by officials of the Department of Social Protection; an appeals process is also available.

CHAPTER 3

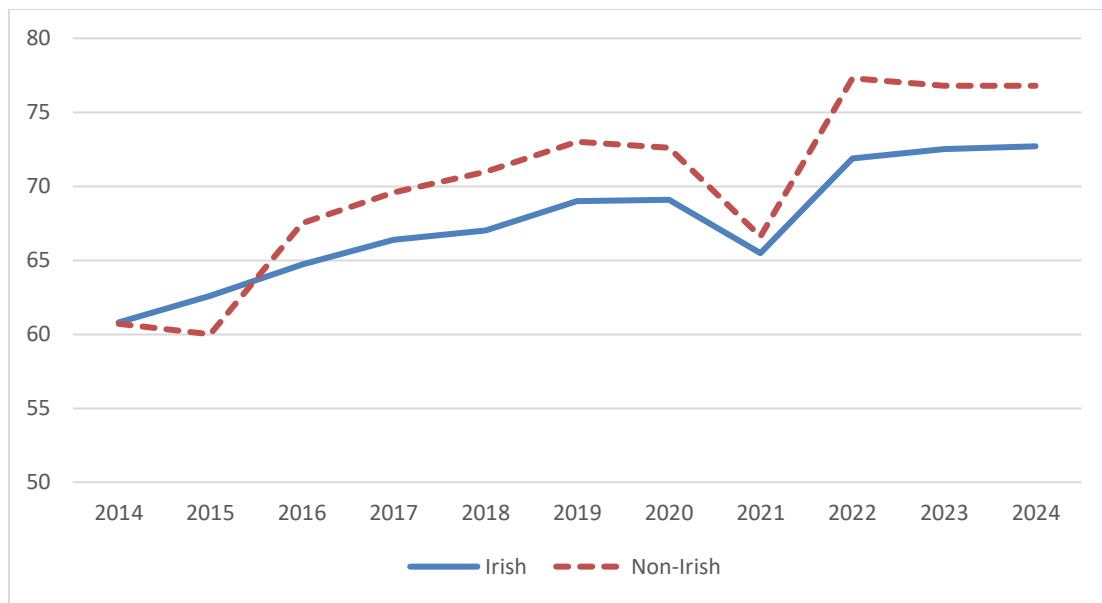
Trends in employment, unemployment and activity

As many social welfare payments are related to labour market status, this chapter includes information on trends in labour force status between immigrants and native Irish people from 2014–2024. While high and sustained rates of employment are likely to reduce reliance on welfare payments, such rates will increase eligibility for contributory payments related to unemployment and disability, amongst others. High rates of unemployment are likely to increase demand for the relevant payments but eligibility limits, due to weak contribution histories or the habitual residency condition, will lessen rates of receipt.

For over a decade, the ESRI has produced a biennial report in which the integration of immigrants in Ireland is measured and tracked (see, for example, McGinnity et al., 2025 and McGinnity et al., 2023). Drawing on the Labour Force Survey, the authors of those reports have recorded rates of employment, unemployment and activity for immigrants and Irish people. In the following charts, we have gathered these data.

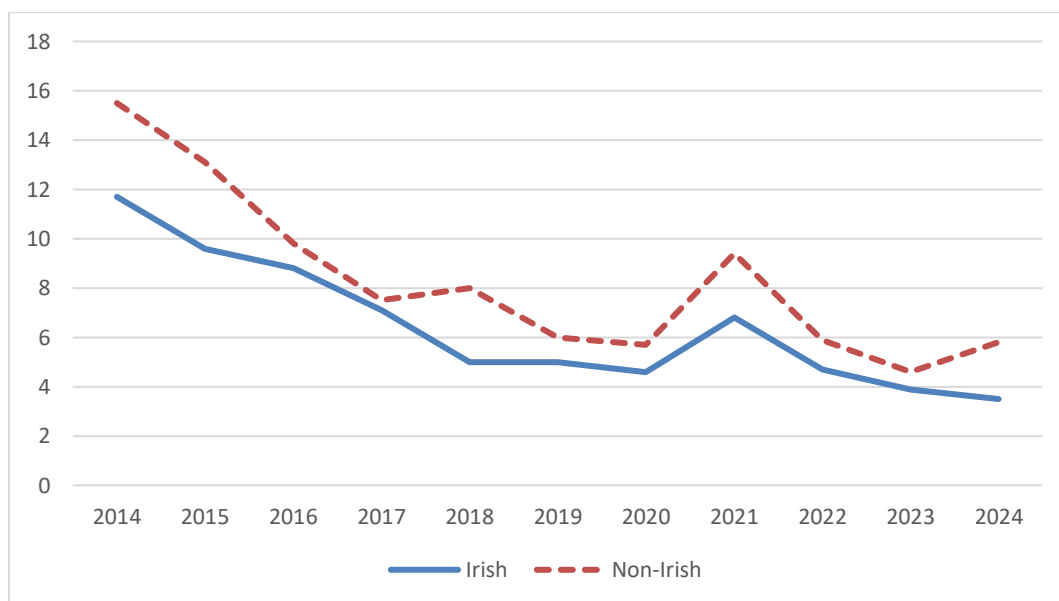
It is useful to provide a reminder of the definitions of the variables shown in the charts. Based on the International Labour Organization (ILO) definitions, the employment rate is the proportion of the working age population (15–64) who have done any paid work in the previous week; the unemployment rate is the proportion of the labour force who are not employed but have sought work in the last month; the activity rate is the proportion of the working age population who are either employed or unemployed.

Looking first at employment rates in Figure 3.1, a number of interesting features emerge. Following the recession, which was particularly destructive for immigrant employment, the post-recession recovery was underway in 2014 for the employment rates of Irish people. But the recovery in immigrant employment rates took off between 2015 and 2016 and the employment rates of immigrants have exceeded those of Irish people ever since. Both groups suffered a decline in employment rates around the COVID-19 crisis, and the convergence of the rates points to a steeper decline among immigrants. Post-COVID-19, an immigrant employment rate advantage for immigrants re-emerged. Over the full ten-year period, the average percentage point differential was 2.7 in favour of immigrants, but this has been over 4 between 2022 and 2024.

FIGURE 3.1 EMPLOYMENT RATES BY COUNTRY OF BIRTH, 2014–2024

Source: CSO Labour Force Survey.

In Figure 3.2, we show the trend in relative unemployment rates. As was the case in Figure 3.1, the post-recession recovery is evident for both groups with unemployment rates falling between 2014 and 2020. The COVID-19 crisis is also evident for both, and the post-COVID-19 recovery. Throughout the period, unemployment rates are higher for immigrants with the percentage point difference averaging 1.9.

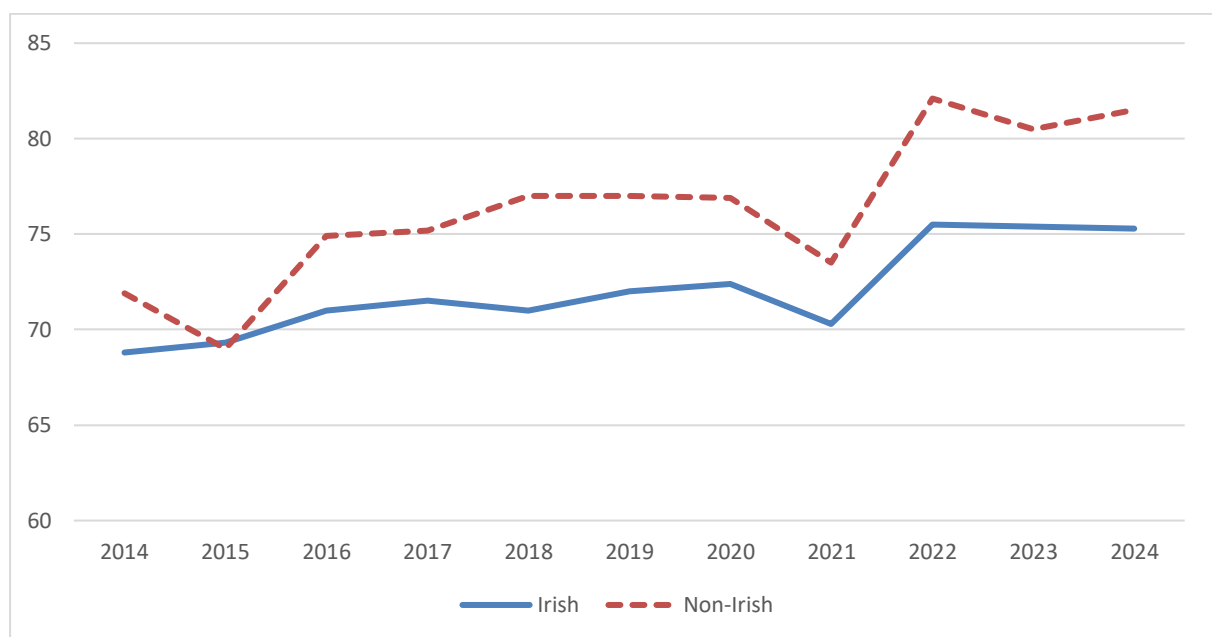
FIGURE 3.2 UNEMPLOYMENT RATES BY COUNTRY OF BIRTH, 2014–2024

Source: CSO Labour Force Survey.

That both employment and unemployment rates have been higher (generally) for immigrants is explained in Figure 3.3, where we present activity rates. With one exception (2015), activity rates have been higher for immigrants with the percentage point differential averaging 4.3 over the period.

With both higher employment and unemployment rates, it is unclear based solely on labour force status whether we should expect immigrants to have higher or lower rates of welfare receipt compared to Irish people. In the next section, we look directly at this question.

FIGURE 3.3 ACTIVITY RATES BY COUNTRY OF BIRTH, 2014–2024



Source: CSO Labour Force Survey.

CHAPTER 4

Empirical analysis

This study relies on data from the Irish Survey on Income and Living Conditions (SILC), a nationally representative survey conducted annually by the Central Statistics Office (CSO) since 2004. SILC forms Ireland's contribution to the wider European Union Statistics on Income and Living Conditions (EU-SILC) coordinated by Eurostat. Its primary purpose is to collect detailed information on household income, living standards and key socio-demographic characteristics such as education, health and labour-market status. SILC is the official data source for monitoring poverty, income inequality and living conditions in both Ireland and Europe. Between 4,000 and 5,500 private households are surveyed each year in Ireland. Because SILC focuses exclusively on private households, some population groups are not captured, including individuals living in International Protection Accommodation Services (IPAS) and people experiencing homelessness. The analysis in this study is based on SILC data from 2014 to 2024 and covers the population aged 18 to 65, regardless of whether they have an income.

In the analyses below, we consider the issue of immigrant welfare receipt relative to the native-born in two ways. First, we look at rates of receipt across immigrants and the native-born based on simple averages and without adjusting for socio-economic characteristics which might impact on rates of receipt. Second, we look again at relative rates of receipt but this time adjusting for socio-economic characteristics. The first approach provides insight on the extent to which immigrant groups draw on the welfare spending of the state. The second approach provides insights on whether immigrants are more likely to access welfare payments compared to Irish-born people with the same characteristics. The results of both approaches are presented below.

4.1 DESCRIPTIVE STATISTICS

We begin our analysis of welfare receipt with Table 4.1. Although we have data for all years between 2014 and 2024, we initially select three years (2014, 2019 and 2024)² and present some descriptive statistics. Looking first at the widest set of welfare payments – unemployment, disability and family/children-related³ – we can see that in 2024, 56 per cent of Irish-born people were in receipt of one or more of these payments. The corresponding figure for immigrants was 61 per cent, and

² We picked those dates as they are the first and last observed years; and 2019 is both the middle year and the last year before the effects of COVID-19 can be observed.

³ For ease of writing, we call family/children-related allowances 'family allowances' throughout the rest of the paper. See Table A.10 in the Appendix for a detailed list of welfare payments grouped under these headings.

the difference is statistically significant. The same pattern held in both 2014 and 2019.

TABLE 4.1 % IN RECEIPT OF SOCIAL WELFARE PAYMENTS AND SOCIO-DEMOGRAPHIC CHARACTERISTICS BY COUNTRY OF BIRTH (2014, 2019, 2024)

Year →	2014		2019		2024	
Country of birth →	Irish	Non-Irish	Irish	Non-Irish	Irish	Non-Irish
Unemployment, disability, family allowance	69	76*	65	71**	56	61**
Unemployment benefits	19	21	14	14	9	9
Disability allowances	13	10**	13	10**	6	4*
Family allowances	53	66***	52	63***	47	58***
Unemployment, sickness, disability	31	31	26	24	23	20
Demographics						
Unemployed	13	15	6	9**	3	4
Post-secondary education	52	67***	60	70***	66	71*
Mean years of work	21	17	21	18	23	19
Mean age	44	41	45	42	45	41
N cases	5,287	1,128	3,899	1,035	4,952	961

Note: * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born. We do not report separate results for sickness benefits as CSO data rules require at least 30 observations per variable, which is not the case for that variable.

Looking at each benefit type separately, we can see that the observation of higher rates of receipt by immigrants is driven by the family allowance category. For example, in 2024, 47 per cent of the Irish-born were receiving such a payment compared to 58 per cent of immigrants. There are no statistically significant differences between immigrants and the Irish-born with regard to unemployment payments. For disability payments, immigrants in each of the three years are found to have lower rates of receipt. While there are not enough observations to analyse sickness payments by themselves, we see that adding them up with unemployment and disability payment results in no significant differences between the native- and foreign-born.

Table 4.1 also includes descriptive statistics on the socio-economic variables which we will include in the regression analysis below. The observation in Figure 3.2 of higher rates of unemployment among immigrants is repeated in Table 4.1, for the years 2014 and 2019. But the most recent years show no statistically significant differences between the unemployment rates. Immigrants are shown to have higher levels of education than the Irish-born and this is a finding which has been present in much research on immigration in Ireland (see McGinnity et al. 2023 and 2025).

In Table 4.2, we re-orient our focus by looking at all years combined, but breaking out the immigrant group into a range of regional origins, where the groupings are determined by the CSO⁴. Differences across the immigrant groups now become apparent. Looking at the combined category of ‘unemployment, disability and family’, we can see immigrants from the EU West (pre-2004 EU less the UK) are less likely to be in receipt of benefits, as are immigrants in the ‘other’ category. We observe relatively higher rates of receipt for immigrants from the UK, the newer Member States of the EU (EU East⁵), Africa and Asia. Looking just at unemployment payments, two sets of immigrants have lower rates of receipt (EU West and Asia) while two have higher rates (EU East and Africa). For family allowances, we see higher rates of receipt among immigrants from EU East, Asia and Africa.

Turning to the socio-economic variables, where there are statistically significant differences in unemployment rates, these are higher for immigrants (UK, EU East, Asia and Africa). Once again, the high level of education among Ireland’s immigrants is seen in Table 4.2 and it is notable that this applies to all the regional categories.

TABLE 4.2 % IN RECEIPT OF SOCIAL WELFARE PAYMENTS AND SOCIO-DEMOGRAPHIC CHARACTERISTICS BY DETAILED COUNTRY/REGION OF BIRTH (2014–2024, POOLED)

Country of birth →	IE	UK	EU West	EU East	Asia	Africa	Other
Unemployment, disability, family allowance	64	66**	55***	78***	71***	75***	56***
Unemployment benefits	16	17	13**	21***	12***	21***	14
Disability benefits	9	12***	3***	7***	4***	5***	3***
Family benefits	51	51	51	72***	67***	68***	48
Unemployment, sickness, disability	29	32***	17***	35***	20***	26	21***
Demographics							
Unemployed	7	10***	5	9***	9**	12***	7
Post-secondary education	60	66***	84***	61	84***	76***	78***
Mean years of work	21	24	17	16	15	18	17
Mean age	44	48	40	38	40	43	39
N cases	50,100	3,686	993	3,223	1,268	742	1,096

Note: * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born. We do not report separate results for sickness benefits as CSO data rules require at least 30 observations per variable, which is not the case for that variable.

⁴ See Appendix section A.II for a full list of countries included in each region.

⁵ With some abuse of terminology, we use the term ‘EU-Eastern-born’ and ‘Eastern Europeans’ interchangeability throughout the paper.

4.2 REGRESSION ANALYSIS

In Table 4.3, we report on our regression analysis. The key point of interest is whether any observed differences in the propensity to receive welfare payments between immigrants and natives changes when we control for factors which might be related to differing socio-economic profiles across the two groups. Given the variation in immigrant groups by region of birth observed in Table 4.2, we breakout the immigrant population into those groups in our regressions.

The dependent variable in the regressions is a dummy variable indicating whether an individual received a welfare payment. Given the binary nature of the dependent variable, we estimate a probit model rather than a linear regression model. Following standard practice, we report the estimated marginal impacts in Table 4.3 and subsequent tables rather than coefficients. In each regression, a categorical variable showing the different regions of birth is included, and the base category is always being born in Ireland. Hence, the estimated marginal impacts for each immigrant category measures the percentage difference in the likelihood of welfare receipt between the Irish-born and the immigrant group.

In Table 4.3, we look at all welfare payments. Thus, the dependent variable is one if any type of payment (i.e. unemployment, disability or family allowances) was received and zero otherwise. The first column shows the estimated marginal effects when only the immigrant dummies and year dummies are included, but no other socio-economic characteristics. As can be seen, some of the variation across immigrant groups evident in Table 4.2 is shown again. Immigrants from EU West are 9 percentage points (pp) less likely than the Irish-born to be receiving welfare and the corresponding figure for immigrants in the 'other' category is 6 pp. We observe higher rates of receipt for immigrants from the UK, EU East, Asia and Africa with the largest difference between the Irish-born and immigrant being seen for EU East immigrants (15 pp).

As we move across the columns in Table 4.3, we are reporting on regressions where an extra control is added sequentially. Based on past literature (including Barrett et al., 2013), these are age, gender, marital status, education, years of work and the presence of children. In the final regression, we also add year dummies which are interacted with immigrant dummies. If we focus on the EU East group – those with highest positive marginal effect – we can see that the estimated marginal effect shrinks quite dramatically when the controls are added, moving from an estimated 15 pp differential to just 3 pp. For the Asian and African groups, the estimated marginal effect changes sign when the controls are added. Once we adjust for the socio-economic characteristics, both immigrants from Africa and Asia are found to be 4 pp less likely to be in receipt of payments.

TABLE 4.3 UNEMPLOYMENT, DISABILITY AND FAMILY ALLOWANCES, PROBIT MARGINAL EFFECTS ADDING ONE COVARIATE AT A TIME (2014–2024, POOLED)

Controls →	Year	+ Age	+ Gender	+ Marital status	+ Education	+ Years of work	+ Children	+ Year interaction
Country of birth ↓								i.e. with all controls ↓
UK	0.02*	0.03***	0.03***	0.02**	0.03***	0.03***	0.02**	0.02**
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)
EU West	-0.09***	-0.11***	-0.11***	-0.12***	-0.09***	-0.09***	-0.08***	-0.08***
	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.01)	(0.01)
EU East	0.15***	0.13***	0.13***	0.09***	0.09***	0.09***	0.03***	0.03***
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)
Asia	0.08***	0.07***	0.07***	0.01	0.03*	0.02	-0.05***	-0.04***
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.01)
Africa	0.10***	0.10***	0.10***	0.07***	0.08***	0.08***	-0.05**	-0.04**
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)
Other	-0.06***	-0.08***	-0.08***	-0.13***	-0.10***	-0.10***	-0.03**	-0.04***
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.01)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

In the regressions reported in Table 4.3, family and child-related allowances are included in the dependent variable. As child benefit is a universal payment and is received by a large proportion of both immigrants and natives, it might be playing a distorting role in the regressions. For this reason, in Table 4.4, we restrict the welfare receipt dependent variable to people who have received one of the following payments: unemployment, disability or sickness.

In the first column of Table 4.4, we again show the results where only the country of birth and year of observation are included in the regression. The largest estimated marginal effect in absolute terms is for EU West immigrants – they are 12 percentage points less likely to be in receipt of unemployment, disability or sickness benefits relative to the Irish-born. As we add controls, the estimated marginal effect declines but remains negative and statistically significant.

A somewhat different pattern is observed for EU East immigrants. In the simplest model in column 1, we see an estimated marginal effect which is positive and significant (0.06), indicating that EU East immigrants are more likely to be in receipt of these payments. The estimated marginal effect does not decline with the inclusion of extra controls, so these socio-economic characteristics are not explaining the difference in welfare propensity. The estimated marginal effect for UK immigrants is also positive and statistically significant in the first column (0.03) and remains as such when controls are added.

**TABLE 4.4 UNEMPLOYMENT, DISABILITY AND SICKNESS BENEFITS, PROBIT MARGINAL EFFECTS
ADDING ONE COVARIATE AT A TIME (2014–2024, POOLED)**

Controls →	Year	+ Age	+ Gender	+ Marital status	+ Education	+ Years of work	+ Children	+ Year interaction
Country of birth ↓								i.e. with all controls ↓
UK	0.03*** (0.01)	0.03** (0.01)	0.03** (0.01)	0.02** (0.01)	0.04*** (0.01)	0.03*** (0.01)	0.03*** (0.01)	0.03*** (0.01)
EU West	-0.12*** (0.02)	-0.12*** (0.02)	-0.12*** (0.02)	-0.11*** (0.02)	-0.07*** (0.02)	-0.07*** (0.02)	-0.07*** (0.02)	-0.07*** (0.02)
EU East	0.06*** (0.01)	0.07*** (0.01)	0.07*** (0.01)	0.09*** (0.01)	0.08*** (0.01)	0.08*** (0.01)	0.08*** (0.01)	0.08*** (0.01)
Asia	-0.09*** (0.01)	-0.08*** (0.01)	-0.08*** (0.01)	-0.04*** (0.02)	-0.01 (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)	-0.03 (0.02)
Africa	-0.02 (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)	0.01 (0.02)	-0.01 (0.02)	-0.01 (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)
Other	-0.08*** (0.02)	-0.08*** (0.02)	-0.08*** (0.02)	-0.06*** (0.02)	-0.03 (0.02)	-0.03 (0.02)	-0.03 (0.02)	-0.04*** (0.02)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

As rules around eligibility differ across contributory and non-contributory benefits, it is important to consider each separately, so we do this in Tables 4.5 and 4.6. As noted earlier, contributory benefits require a history of social insurance payments and include unemployment and illness benefits. Non-contributory benefits do not require a history of social insurance payments and include unemployment and disability allowances. We follow the same approach as in Tables 4.3 and 4.4, starting with a simple model and adding extra controls as we move across the column. In Tables 4.5 and 4.6, we look at all benefits combined.

From Table 4.5, we can see that most immigrant groups are less likely to be in receipt of contributory non-means-tested benefits with the exception of EU East immigrants. In the case of EU East immigrants, the estimated marginal effect is positive (0.06) in the first model and changes very little as controls are added. On the other hand, for all the other migrants, even when the full set of controls is added, the estimated marginal effects remain negative and statistically significant.

**TABLE 4.5 ALL CONTRIBUTORY NON-MEANS-TESTED BENEFITS, PROBIT MARGINAL EFFECTS
ADDING ONE COVARIATE AT A TIME (2014–2024, POOLED)**

Controls →	Year	+ Age	+ Gender	+ Marital status	+ Education	+ Years of work	+ Children	+ Year interaction
Country of birth ↓								i.e. with all controls ↓
UK	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.04*** (0.01)
EU West	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)
EU East	0.06*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.05*** (0.01)	0.04*** (0.01)	0.05*** (0.01)	0.04*** (0.01)	0.04*** (0.01)
Asia	-0.05*** (0.01)	-0.05*** (0.01)	-0.05*** (0.01)	-0.07*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)
Africa	-0.09*** (0.01)	-0.09*** (0.01)	-0.09*** (0.01)	-0.10*** (0.01)	-0.09*** (0.01)	-0.09*** (0.01)	-0.10*** (0.01)	-0.10*** (0.01)
Other	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.07*** (0.01)	-0.07*** (0.01)	-0.07*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	-0.07*** (0.01)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

In Table 4.6, we look at non-contributory means-tested benefits. In this set of regressions, the largest marginal effect is for immigrants from Africa. In the first column, the estimated effect indicates that this group is 17 percentage points more likely to be in receipt compared to the Irish-born. The addition of controls does not alter the size of the effect to any great degree. UK and EU East immigrants are also more likely to be in receipt of these benefits, with the estimated effect remaining similar as controls are added. As with the regressions reported above, EU West immigrants are less likely to be receiving benefits – the estimated marginal effect range from 0.11 to 0.07 across the models and are always statistically significant.

**TABLE 4.6 ALL NON-CONTRIBUTORY MEANS-TESTED BENEFITS, PROBIT MARGINAL EFFECTS
ADDING ONE COVARIATE AT A TIME (2014–2024, POOLED)**

Controls →	Year	+ Age	+ Gender	+ Marital status	+ Education	+ Years of work	+ Children	+ Year interaction
Country of birth ↓								i.e. with all controls ↓
UK	0.05*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.05*** (0.01)	0.07*** (0.01)	0.07*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)
EU West	-0.11*** (0.01)	-0.11*** (0.01)	-0.12*** (0.01)	-0.11*** (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.02)	-0.06*** (0.02)	-0.06*** (0.02)	-0.07*** (0.02)
EU East	0.07*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.09*** (0.01)	0.09*** (0.01)	0.09*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)
Asia	-0.08*** (0.01)	-0.08*** (0.01)	-0.08*** (0.01)	-0.03** (0.01)	0.02 (0.02)	-0.01 (0.01)	-0.02 (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)
Africa	0.17*** (0.02)	0.16*** (0.02)	0.16*** (0.02)	0.17*** (0.02)	0.21*** (0.02)	0.18*** (0.02)	0.14*** (0.02)	0.14*** (0.02)
Other	-0.08*** (0.01)	-0.09*** (0.01)	-0.09*** (0.01)	-0.07*** (0.01)	-0.03* (0.02)	-0.03* (0.01)	-0.02 (0.02)	-0.02* (0.01)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

We undertake the same exercise, separating the receipt of unemployment, sickness and disability benefits (USD) between contributory and non-contributory benefits. Column 1 in Table 4.7 shows again that only the EU East population is more likely than the Irish-born to take up these contributory benefits. On the other hand, column 2 shows that the UK, EU East and Africa all have significantly more shares of non-contributory USD recipients than the Irish-born.

TABLE 4.7 UNEMPLOYMENT, SICKNESS, DISABILITY BENEFIT UPTAKE, PROBIT MARGINAL EFFECTS (2014–2024, POOLED)

	(1)	(2)
Dependent variable →	USD contributory, non-means tested	USD non-contributory, means-tested
Country of birth ↓		
UK	-0.02 (0.01)	0.03*** (0.01)
EU West	-0.03*** (0.01)	-0.01 (0.02)
EU East	0.06*** (0.01)	0.02*** (0.01)
Asia	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)
Africa	-0.06*** (0.01)	0.05*** (0.02)
Other	-0.04*** (0.01)	-0.02 (0.01)
Controls	YES	YES
Observations	61,108	61,108

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born. The models use the same control variables as in Table 4.6: age, gender, marital status, education, years of work and number of children.

Undertaking the same exercise for family allowances and unemployment benefits (separately from sickness and disability benefits), we again see in Table 4.8 that African-, UK-, and EU-Eastern-born are significantly more likely to receive non-contributory benefits (columns 2 and 4); and EU-Eastern-born are also more likely to receive contributory unemployment benefits (column 3). On the other hand, most migrant groups are found to be significantly less likely than the Irish-born to receive contributory non-means-tested family allowances⁶, including the EU East (column 1).

⁶ Contributory non-means-tested family allowances include maternity benefit; adoptive parent benefit; carer benefit; deserted wife's benefit; paternity benefit; contributory guardian's payment; parent's benefit; health and safety benefit. Non-contributory means-tested family allowances include back-to-school clothing and footwear allowance; basic supplementary welfare allowance; carer's allowance; one-parent family payment; diet supplement; non-contributory guardian's payment.

TABLE 4.8 FAMILY AND UNEMPLOYMENT UPTAKE, PROBIT MARGINAL EFFECTS (2014–2024, POOLED)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Dependent variable →	Contributory family benefits	Non-contr. family benefits	Contributory unemploy. benefits	Non-contr. unemploy. benefits
Country of birth ↓				
UK	-0.03*** (0.00)	0.04*** (0.01)	-0.00 (0.00)	0.02*** (0.01)
EU West	-0.01* (0.01)	-0.06*** (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	0.00 (0.01)
EU East	-0.02*** (0.00)	0.04*** (0.01)	0.03*** (0.01)	0.03*** (0.01)
Asia	-0.02*** (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	0.00 (.)	-0.00 (0.01)
Africa	0.00 (.)	0.12*** (0.02)	0.00 (.)	0.07*** (0.02)
Other	0.00 (.)	-0.03*** (0.01)	0.00 (.)	0.01 (0.01)
Observations	60,847	61,108	60,822	61,108

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born. The models use the same control variables as in Table 4.6: age, gender, marital status, education, years of work and number of children.

4.3 UNDERSTANDING THE NEW TRENDS

While we saw in the last section that the UK- and African-born are significantly more likely than the Irish-born to receive non-contributory means-tested benefits, it is even more striking to see that EU-Eastern-born individuals are more likely to receive most of the analysed benefits (with the exception of contributory non-means-tested family benefits). This is all the more surprising as Barrett et al. (2013) found the opposite trend in 2008, namely that Eastern Europeans (or ‘new Member States’) received significantly fewer benefits than the Irish-born for all observed benefits. In this section, we analyse some of the potential reasons behind this trend reversal.

4.3.1 Demographical changes (2008–2024)

While the yearly population immigrating to Ireland from the EU East dropped dramatically between 2007 and 2010, it has been stable, at around 10,000, since then (see Appendix Figure A.1). Appendix Table A.1 thus presents changes in other key demographic characteristics since 2008, to help understand the observed changes in social transfer receipts for that group. For comparison, Appendix Table A.2 provides the corresponding figures for the Irish-born population.

First, Appendix Table A.1 shows that the average age of Eastern Europeans has gradually grown from 30 in 2008 to 40 in 2024 (that of the Irish-born stayed at around 40 throughout). Secondly, the share of women has grown from 44 per cent in 2008 to 54 per cent in 2024 (it stayed at around 50 per cent for the Irish-born throughout). Likewise, the share of households with children has grown from 55 per cent in 2008 to 69 per cent in 2024, and the average number of children per household has grown from 0.9 to 1.2 between the two years. We see the opposite trend for the Irish-born, with a drop in the share of households that have children going from 47 per cent in 2008 to 40.5 per cent in 2024. Similarly, the number of children per household went down from 0.9 in 2008 to 0.7 in 2024. The difference in the number of children between Eastern European-born and Irish-born is likely explained by the younger age profile of the formers. Unsurprisingly, the rise in the number of children of Eastern European people coincided with a rise in the share that received family benefits; from 62 per cent in 2008 to 71 per cent in 2024. On the other hand, these figures went down from 58 per cent to 48 per cent for the Irish-born. We also see that the share of households with 2+ adults and children rose from 60 per cent in 2008 to 67 per cent in 2024 for the EU East; while going down from 52 to 38 per cent for the Irish-born.

4.3.2 Changes in labour and education

Appendix Table A.1 also shows that the average years of work of Eastern EU-born gradually rose from eight in 2008 to 18 years in 2024, which coincides with the gradual increase in age. The Irish-born saw a rise in their years of work as well, although at a slower pace, going from 19 in 2008 to 23 years in 2024.

Focusing on the principal economic status, the share of unemployed amongst the Eastern EU labour force⁷ went from 7 per cent in 2008 to 3.5 per cent in 2024. The equivalent figure for the Irish-born went from 12 to 5 per cent. We note that this share climbed to 26 per cent in 2010 for the Eastern EU and remained above 20 per cent until 2013. This is linked to the fact that there was a strong decline in migrant-heavy sectors like construction and manufacturing during the crisis (McGinnity et al., 2012). The share of unemployed then gradually went down to 8 per cent in 2018, before rising back up to 10 per cent in 2019 and 2020. Although the share of unemployed also rose throughout the same years for the Irish-born, it was never as high since it remained below 20 per cent between 2010 and 2013, and below 10 per cent throughout the pandemic.

Looking at the share of Eastern Europeans that received unemployment benefits, it went up from 7 per cent in 2008 to 10 per cent in 2024. Again, we see a surge in this rate between 2010 and 2015 when it remained close to 30 per cent, and in 2021, when it climbed to 36 per cent before going back down. As for the Irish-born,

⁷ The labour force includes the unemployed and the employed, but excludes the inactive population (i.e. those who are not actively seeking work or engaged in any form of employment).

those rates remained around 20 per cent between 2010 and 2015 and climbed up to 27 per cent in 2021 before going down to 9 per cent in 2024.

Thus, while the unemployment rate for Eastern Europeans was closer to that of the Irish-born during the years of sustainable economic growth, they were disproportionately affected during the economic downturns.

When looking at education, we see that the share of Eastern Europeans who went beyond upper secondary education started at 55 per cent in 2008, then remained close to 60 per cent between 2009 and 2020, before gradually dropping down to 51 per cent in 2024. Meanwhile, those figures started at 36 per cent for the Irish-born in 2008, increased gradually up to 61 per cent in 2020, before going slightly down although remaining close to 60 per cent since that year.

4.3.3 Gelbach decomposition

In order to further understand why the Eastern European population has been more likely to receive benefits than the Irish-born since 2014, we undertake a Gelbach decomposition (Gelbach, 2016). This exercise builds directly on the omitted-variable bias framework to help interpret how each covariate contributes to the total change associated with adding all controls. For this part of the analysis, we compare being born in Eastern Europe versus being born in Ireland, and omit the people born in other countries from our sample.

As the higher uptake by Eastern Europeans is most visible when looking at non-contributory means-tested (NCMT) family allowances and unemployment benefits, we focus on these outcomes for this exercise.

Appendix Table A.3 shows that differences in post-secondary education attainment between the EU East and the Irish-born explain the largest share of the fall in the gap in family allowance uptake between the two groups as the full set of controls is added. This is followed by differences in years of work experience and age. In contrast, the higher average number of children in Eastern European households works in the opposite direction: once this factor is controlled for, the disparity in family allowance uptake between the two groups decreases by about 17 per cent.

Appendix Table A.4 shows a similar pattern when examining unemployment benefits. Differences in years of work experience, education and age account for the largest share of the explained disparity between Eastern EU and Irish-born individuals, while controlling for the number of children reduces the coefficient associated with being born in the Eastern EU by 17 per cent as well.

4.3.4 Regression analysis: evolution over the years

Subsections 4.3.1 and 4.3.2 showed that the population of Eastern Europeans in Ireland changed over the years. We thus re-do some of the regression analyses, separating year by year in order to decipher any time trend. As family allowances and unemployment benefits were those that showed the strongest differences between the Irish- and foreign-born in Section 4.2, we focus on these two, separating between contributory and non-contributory benefits.

Focusing first on contributory non-means-tested family allowances, Appendix Table A.5 shows that whenever there were significant differences between the Irish- and foreign-born throughout the years, the foreign-born were less likely to receive these benefits. But when focusing on non-contributory family allowances, Appendix Table A.6 shows that the EU Eastern-born were significantly more likely to receive these in 2014, 2020 and 2022, while this was the case for the African-born from 2014 to 2018, in 2020, and in 2023. This pattern coincides with the post-crisis and post-COVID-19 periods. For African-born individuals, the elevated likelihood of receiving non-contributory family allowances persisted until 2018, which aligns with the period during which labour market access for applicants in the international protection system was restricted. The introduction of employment rights in 2018 may have reduced some of these constraints, although structural labour market barriers likely remained.

When looking at unemployment benefits, Appendix Table A.7 shows that the EU Eastern-born were more likely to receive the contributory non-means-tested benefits from 2015 to 2017 and from 2020 to 2023. All other foreign-born were either not significantly different, or less likely to receive these benefits than the Irish-born. These differential results between foreign regions might be explained by the fact that there was a strong growth in immigration from the EU East since 2004, when these countries entered the European Union, as Ireland was one of the few EU countries (alongside the UK and Sweden) to open its labour market to them (Kumar and Donoghue, 2023). But these populations were particularly hit by the 2008 crisis, and the effects on their employment were observed until 2013, as shown in Section 4.3.2 and in Appendix Table A.1. However, given their employment history since 2004, they might have been more likely to be entitled to contributory benefits than other foreign-born during the economic downturn.

Finally, looking at non-contributory means-tested unemployment benefits, Appendix Table A.8 shows that the EU East was only more likely to receive these in 2014, while the African-born were more likely in 2016 and 2023.

In conclusion, when significant differences were observed between the foreign-born and the Irish-born, the foreign-born were less likely to receive contributory benefits especially, except from the EU East, who were more likely in specific times. Those born in Africa were also more likely to receive non-contributory benefits in some of the observed years but for both groups, these higher benefit receiving

rates were mostly visible following economic downturns, suggesting a stronger scarring effect for them than for the Irish-born and other foreign groups.

4.3.5 Focusing on the unemployed

Before leaving the analysis of the SILC data, we consider one further question. In the analysis above, we have included all individuals in the data but we now want to focus on people who were unemployed at the time of the survey. We repeat the multivariate analysis above but now we are asking if there are differences in the rates of receipt of unemployment payments for people who are unemployed. The results are shown in Appendix Table A.9 and it can be seen that generally, there are no statistically significant differences between the Irish- and the foreign-born populations, including those from the EU East. Only when analysing contributory and non-contributory unemployment payments combined do we see that the Asian-born are significantly less likely to receive unemployment benefits than the Irish-born.

CHAPTER 5

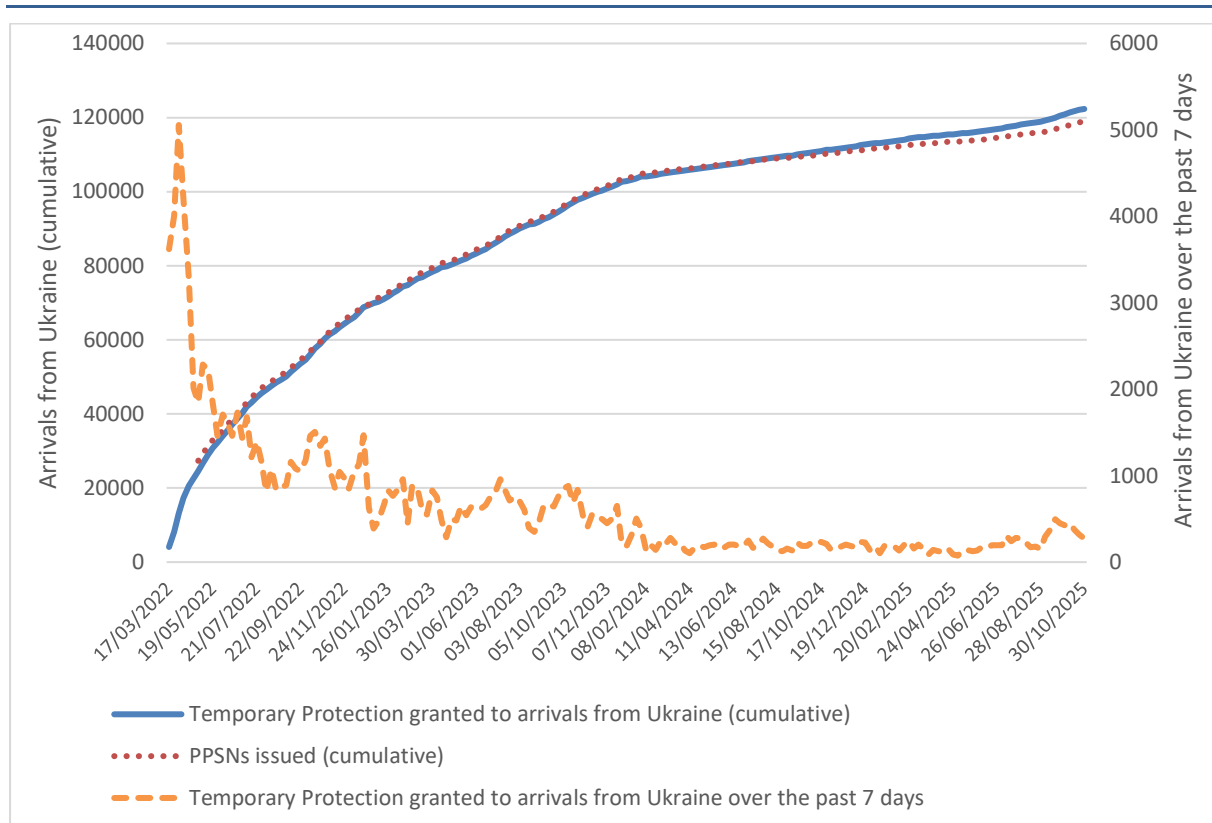
Arrivals from Ukraine

Following Russia's invasion of Ukraine on 24 February 2022, millions of Ukrainians fled the conflict, relocating both within Ukraine and abroad, particularly to EU countries. An estimated 5 million people left Ukraine in the aftermath of the Russian invasion (UNHCR, 2024). To address this humanitarian crisis, EU Member States implemented the Temporary Protection Directive, granting refugees access to accommodation, welfare, healthcare and education, as well as the right to work and reside in the EU. Ireland adopted this directive, providing immediate access to the labour market, social protection and other state supports to arrivals from Ukraine. As people in this group are not well captured in the data used for the previous chapter, their labour market situation and welfare receipt is discussed here using alternative data sources.

5.1 POPULATION ESTIMATES OF ARRIVALS FROM UKRAINE TO IRELAND

Arrivals from Ukraine to Ireland received Temporary Protection and a PPSN to access welfare supports. Figure 5.1 shows the cumulative number of people granted Temporary Protection in Ireland. Arrivals from Ukraine rose sharply between March 2022 and October 2023, then slowed considerably from late 2023 onward, reaching over 122,000 individuals by September 2025. PPSN allocations followed a similar trend, with a slight divergence after late 2024.

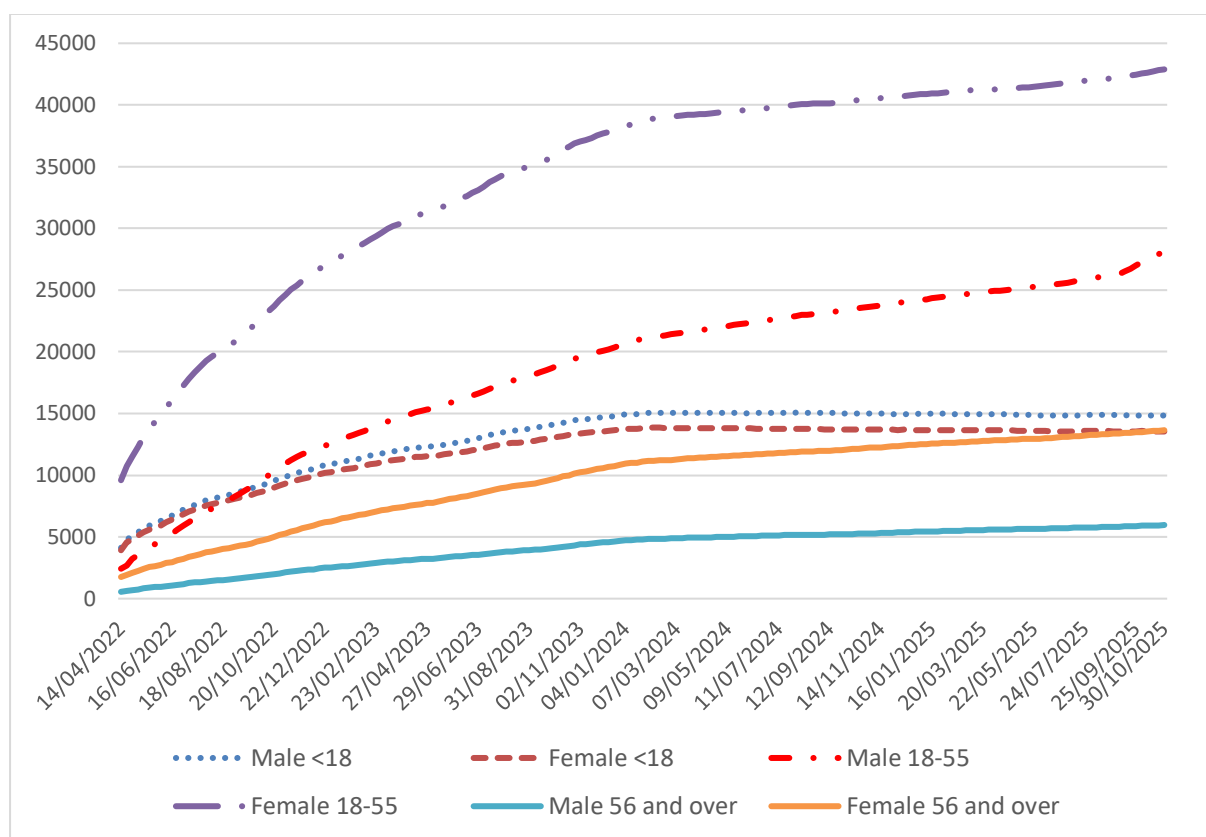
Weekly arrivals (green line) peaked at slightly above 5,000 people in late March 2022, then declined sharply to around 120 by February 2024. After stabilising for several months, arrivals began rising again in September 2025 with almost 500 people per week.

FIGURE 5.1 CUMULATIVE AND OVER THE PAST 7 DAYS TEMPORARY PROTECTION GRANTED AND PPSNS ISSUED

Source: CSO; <https://data.cso.ie/table/UA36>.

5.2 AGE AND GENDER PROFILE

Based on the cumulative number of PPSNs issued, Figure 5.2 shows that most arrivals from Ukraine were adults aged 18–55, predominantly female. Female arrivals increased sharply until early 2024, then grew at a slower pace. Male arrivals in this age group rose more gradually. Children were the second-largest age group, with little gender difference. The number of children grew until late 2023 before stabilising. Arrivals of people aged 56 and over were fewer and mostly female, with slower growth particularly among males compared to their counterparts aged 18 to 55.

FIGURE 5.2 GENDER AND AGE OF ARRIVALS FROM UKRAINE BY PPSNS ISSUED

Source: CSO; <https://data.cso.ie/table/UA38>.

5.3 RETENTION IN IRELAND

Arrival numbers from Ukraine based on the allocation of Temporary Protection status or PPSNs do not reflect how many people remained in Ireland, as some returned to Ukraine or moved to other countries. Since there are no exit records, the CSO released estimates of retention by tracking their activities in administrative data (e.g. attending Intreo events or SOLAS courses, welfare payment receipts, receiving childcare schemes, employment records, address changes with the Department of Social Protection).

Table 5.1 shows that the percentage of people remaining in Ireland declined over time, from 89 per cent after July 2022 to 70 per cent after March 2025 with almost no gender differences. After that date, just over 80,000 people who had arrived from Ukraine were remaining in Ireland.

TABLE 5.1 ADMINISTRATIVE ACTIVITY RATES OF ARRIVALS FROM UKRAINE (2022–2025)

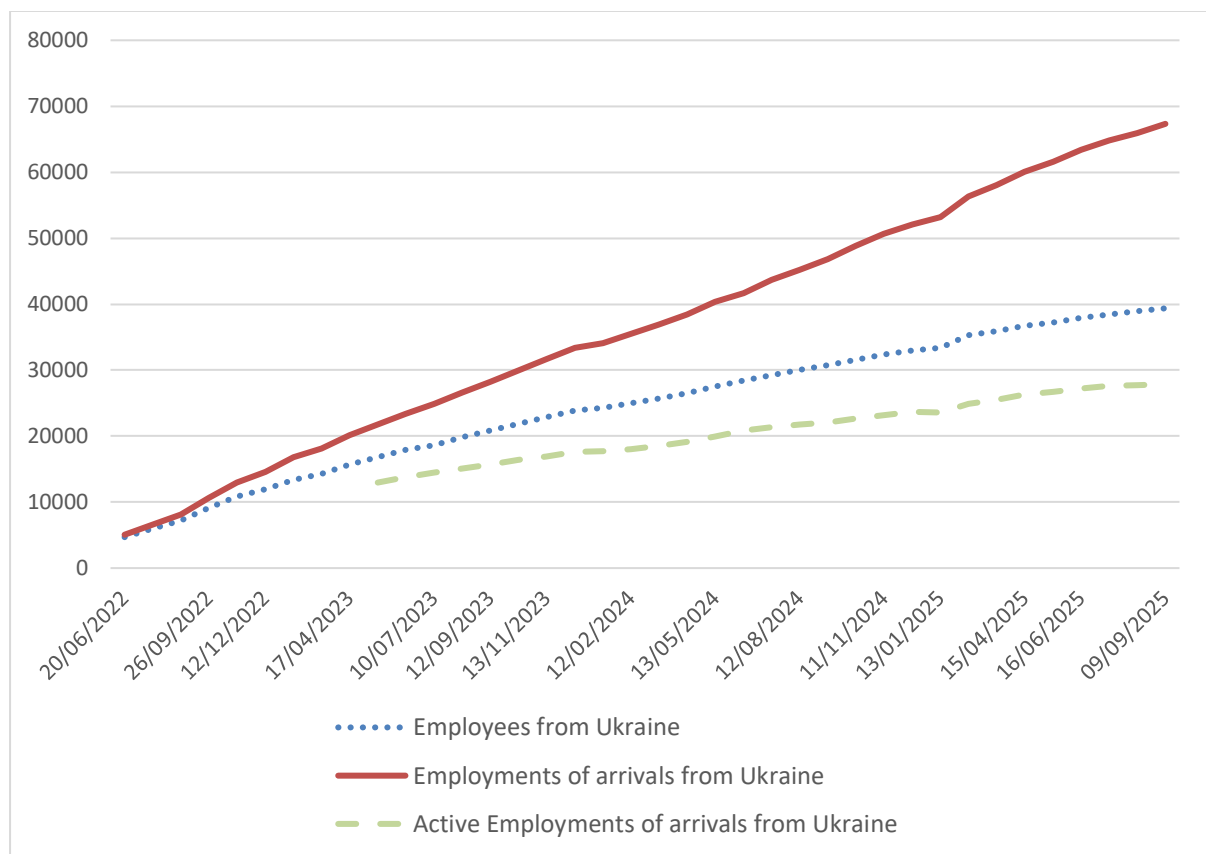
Date	Male	Female	Total
After 31 July 2022	88.5%	89.7%	89.3%
After 31 August 2022	89.0%	89.0%	89.0%
After 30 September 2022	87.1%	87.3%	87.2%
After 31 March 2023	83.8%	84.8%	84.4%
After 31 July 2023	82.0%	82.0%	82.0%
After 30 November 2023	78.1%	78.2%	78.1%
After 31 March 2024	75.8%	75.5%	75.6%
After 30 June 2024	75.6%	74.4%	74.9%
After 30 November 2024	71.9%	70.6%	71.2%
After 31 March 2025	71.4%	69.5%	70.3%

Source: CSO 'Arrivals from Ukraine Series' and authors' calculations.

Note: The Ukraine Series is part of the CSO Frontier Series, meaning the statistics may rely on developing methods or incomplete administrative data. They should thus be interpreted with caution.

5.4 EMPLOYMENT

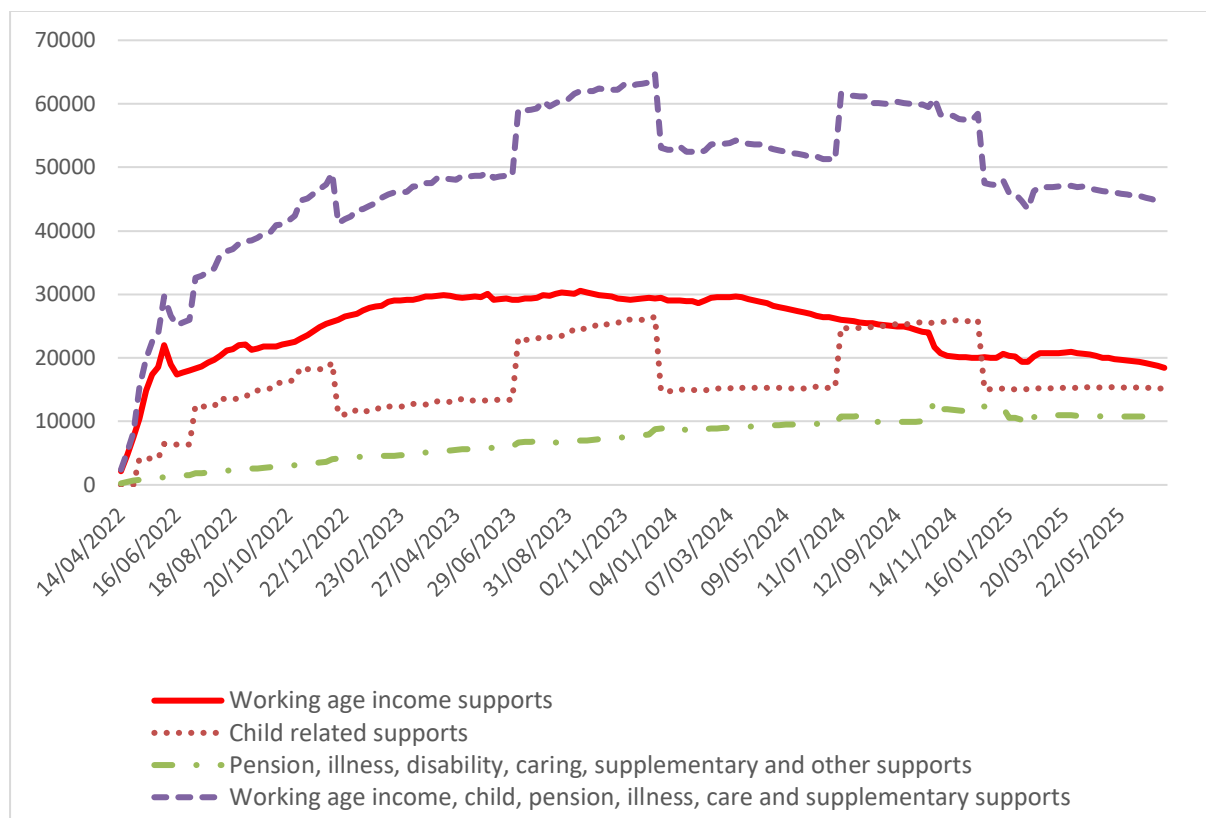
Temporary Protection allowed refugees from Ukraine to work immediately. Figure 5.3 shows employment among arrivals using several different indicators. The orange line captures all recorded employments, both current and past and includes cases where people had several jobs, showing a steady increase over the period. The blue line shows the number of employees, while the green line represents the number of active employments. In this context, active employment refers to verified administrative data sources of current paid employment and is used as an indicator of recent participation in the labour market. The number of active employments doubled between May 2023 and September 2025, rising from nearly 13,000 to almost 28,000.

FIGURE 5.3 EMPLOYMENT AMONG ARRIVALS FROM UKRAINE (2022–2025)

Source: CSO; <https://data.cso.ie/table/UA29>.

5.5 WELFARE SUPPORTS

Temporary Protection also entitled arrivals to receive welfare payments. Figure 5.4 shows trends by welfare payment type, along with the combined total of the three detailed payments (shown by the largest blue line). The chart shows the number of benefits issued rather than the number of recipients, as an individual can receive more than one payment. Child-related supports and working-age income supports mirrored the age profile of arrivals, peaking around February 2023 at nearly 30,000 recipients before gradually declining. This decrease reflects reduced arrivals, departures from Ireland, and increased labour market participation. The sharp increase and fall in child-related support claims is driven by uptake of the Back-to-School Clothing and Footwear Allowance. Although this support is paid only once, it is recorded as a claim throughout the summer from June to the end of October. Pension-related payments remained low, increasing only slightly over time.

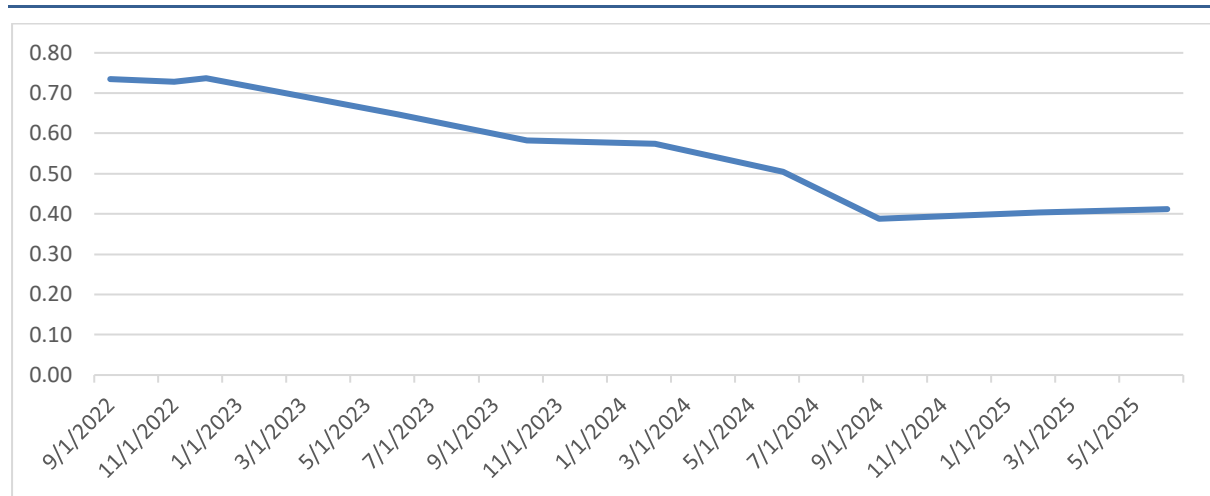
FIGURE 5.4 ACTIVE WELFARE CLAIMS OF ARRIVALS FROM UKRAINE (2022–2025)

Source: CSO; <https://data.cso.ie/table/UA08>.

5.6 WORKING-AGE INCOME SUPPORTS

Focusing on the working-age population (aged 18 to 64), Figure 5.5 presents estimates of the rate at which individuals receive working-age income supports. As noted earlier, these estimates should be interpreted with caution as they are derived from the number of working-age people with recorded activity in administrative data and the number receiving such income supports. Working-age income supports include payments such as the basic Supplementary Welfare Allowance, Jobseeker's Allowance and other schemes. Figure 5.5 shows that the income support receipt rate was above 0.7 in early 2022 up to early 2023, after which it declined steadily, stabilising at around 0.4 from late 2024 onwards. This downward trend likely reflects the increasing share of the working-age population from Ukraine who are entering employment or experiencing rising earnings.⁸

⁸ For the recent period, see for example Table 7 in the CSO publication 'Arrivals from Ukraine in Ireland series 17', www.cso.ie/en/releasesandpublications/fp/p-ai/arrivalsfromukraineinirelandseries17.

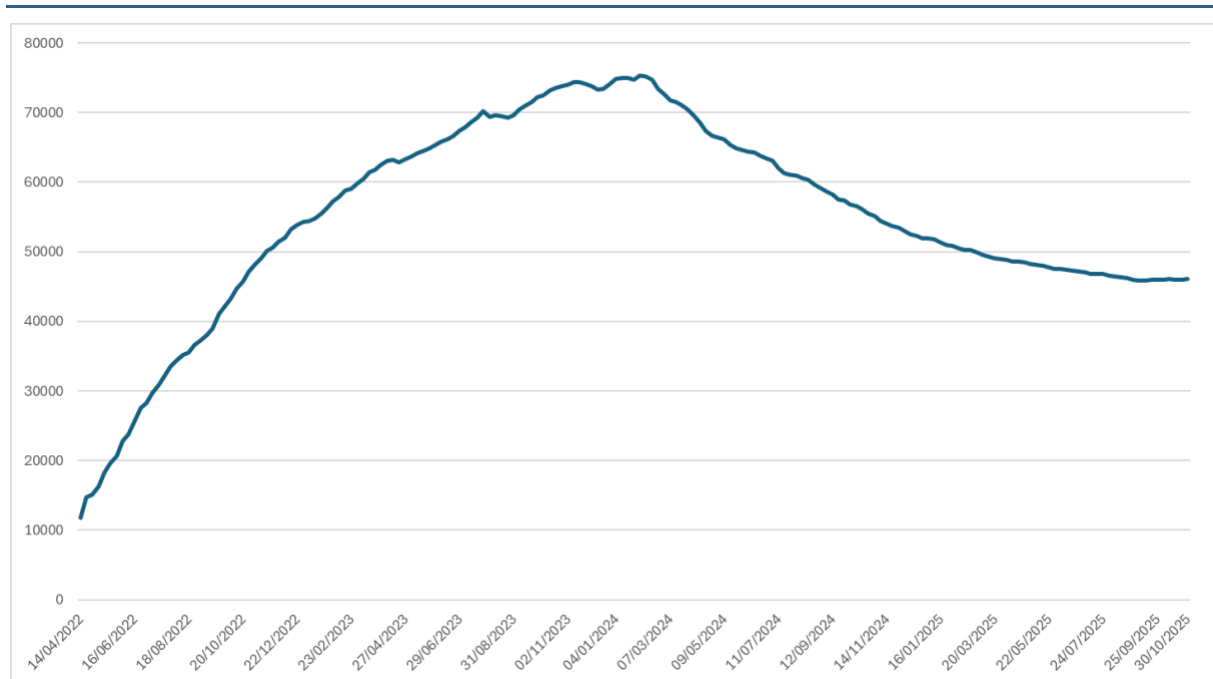
FIGURE 5.5 RATE OF RECEIPTS OF WORKING-AGE INCOME SUPPORTS OF ARRIVALS FROM UKRAINE (2022–2025)

Source: Calculation from the authors based on the CSO publication, 'Arrivals from Ukraine in Ireland series' and <https://data.cso.ie/table/UA08>.

Note: This release is part of the CSO Frontier Series, meaning the statistics may rely on developing methods or incomplete administrative data, so they should be interpreted with caution.

5.7 HOUSING SUPPORT

Beneficiaries of Temporary Protection (BoTPs) arriving from Ukraine received housing support upon arrival. This support took various forms and evolved over time, including emergency accommodation (which closed on 9 April 2024), independent accommodation, serviced accommodation and designated accommodation centres. The number of BoTPs in these arrangements rose sharply from nearly 12,000 in mid-April 2022 to a peak of just over 75,000 in early February 2023, before gradually declining to around 46,000, similar to October 2022 levels (Figure 5.6).

FIGURE 5.6 NUMBER OF BENEFICIARIES OF TEMPORARY PROTECTION (BOTPS) FROM UKRAINE IN ALLOCATED ACCOMMODATION (2022–2025)

Source: CSO; <https://data.cso.ie/table/UA33>.

Since 1 June 2025 and continuing until 31 March 2026, the Department of Social Protection offers the Accommodation Recognition Payment (ARP), a tax-free payment of €600 per month for each property used to accommodate BoTPs from Ukraine for a minimum of six months.⁹ Since late 2024, the number of BoTPs living at addresses where hosts applied for ARP has grown moderately, rising from around 32,500 to nearly 40,000 by mid-2025 (Figure 5.7)¹⁰.

⁹ The payment can be backdated to March 2022 with rates that have varied over time.

¹⁰ The number of ARP beneficiaries is included within the independent accommodation category, which contributes to the aggregated total shown in Figure 5.6.

FIGURE 5.7 NUMBER OF BENEFICIARIES OF TEMPORARY PROTECTION (BOTPS) AND ADDRESSES IN RECEIPT OF ACCOMMODATION RECOGNITION PAYMENT (ARP) (2022–2025)



Source: CSO; <https://data.cso.ie/table/UA42>.

Arrivals from Ukraine to Ireland rose sharply after the 2022 Russian invasion, reaching over 122,000 people by 2025, with most being women aged 18 to 55 and children. People from Ukraine moved in and out of Ireland as shown with declining retention rates from about 89 per cent in mid-2022 to around 70 per cent by early 2025. Employment among arrivals from Ukraine increased steadily while reliance on income supports fell markedly. Welfare and housing supports followed demographic and policy patterns, with child-related claims peaking seasonally and housing supports initially expanding rapidly up to early 2024 before declining and stabilising by late 2025.

CHAPTER 6

Conclusions

As noted at the outset of this report, the characteristics and impacts of immigrants are longstanding issues of debate in Ireland and internationally and that debate has intensified in recent years. The objective of the analysis in the report has been to explore one dimension of the debate, namely, whether immigrants are more or less likely to receive welfare payments compared to the native-born.

Using data from the CSO's Survey on Income and Living Conditions (SILC) from 2014 to 2024, and focusing on the receipt of unemployment, sickness/disability, and family/children-related welfare payments, the picture that emerged from the analysis is complex and there is no single answer as to whether rates of welfare receipt are higher among immigrants. For example, when we looked at rates of receipt for unemployment payments, the rate for the Irish-born pooled across 2014 to 2024 was 16 per cent. Immigrants from EU West and Asia had lower rates of receipt (13 per cent and 12 per cent respectively) whereas immigrants from the EU East and Africa had higher rates (21 per cent for both).

When we adjusted the raw percentages for socio-economic characteristics that are typically related to welfare receipt, a similarly complicated picture persisted. For example, in the case of contributory-based payments related to unemployment, sickness and disability, the regression analysis shows higher rates of receipt for immigrants from the EU East and lower rates for immigrants from the EU West, Asia and Africa. For non-contributory payments of the same type, the results indicate higher receipt rates among immigrants from EU East countries and from Africa. The observations of higher rates of receipt among EU East immigrants is in contrast to findings from earlier research which looked at immigrants in the mid-to-late 2000s. A comparison of this group across the earlier and current periods shows a changing demographic make-up.

Using a different data source with the CSO Ukraine Hub Statistics, we conducted a separate analysis of the recent inflow of Ukrainian immigrants as this group is not well captured in the SILC data. While rates of welfare receipt among this group were high when the large-scale inflow began in 2022, rates of receipt have declined over time. We also conducted a more in-depth analysis of immigrants from the EU East. Earlier research by Barrett et al. (2013), which focused on the period preceding the Great Recession, had found much lower rates of receipt among this group compared to the native-born, but the more recent data showed higher rates of receipt. Comparing the earlier and later cohorts, we found that immigrants from the EU East were now older, more female and with more children.

The varied picture across immigrant groups and across payment types means that simple and straightforward policy conclusions are not readily applicable, but two core findings are worth highlighting. First, there is generally no evidence of much greater rates of welfare receipt among immigrants compared to the native-born. Even where higher rates are found, the differences are not large. Second, when we explored rates of receipt of unemployment payments across people who were unemployed at the time of the survey, no immigrant group was found to be more likely to have received an unemployment payment compared to the native-born. To the extent that some groups of immigrants were found to have higher rates of receipt when we considered the full sample, this seems to be more related to immigrants experiencing longer periods of unemployment, especially during economic downturns, than a greater probability of receiving payments in any given period of unemployment.

Based on these points and on the broader set of results, we would argue that there is no overall evidence of a systematic difference in welfare receipt rates between immigrants and the native-born. Immigrants, like the native-born that are eligible, have access to welfare supports and this is a positive feature of Ireland's welfare system. We know from previous research that some groups of immigrants experience labour market challenges and so supports for this group can be valuable in aiding exits from welfare. Such interventions can be viewed as part of the broader suite of supports which are offered to all eligible people, both native-born and immigrants. However, to the extent that some groups of immigrants experience labour market and other forms of discrimination, there may be a role for programmes which assist immigrants in overcoming discrimination-based barriers. Policies combating discrimination should also play a role but the changing of attitudes can be slow. An additional issue which can face recipients on international protection is the time spent out of the labour market during the asylum-seeking period. Time out of the labour market can have a scarring effect on all groups, but the effects are likely to be compounded in the case of refugees.

We should note that a significant limitation of the study relates to the omission of international protection applicants. As the SILC data do not include people living in congregated settings, we miss this important group. Another limitation arises from the absence of data on time spent in Ireland by immigrants. Many studies of immigrants internationally observe how the experiences of individual immigrants can change over time in their host countries if, for example, they acquire language and other skills which facilitate their integration into the labour market. This longitudinal dimension could be important in the context of welfare receipt. A final limitation to note is that the results are limited in providing insights on the longer run.

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APPENDIX

A.I KEY FACTS ABOUT INTERNATIONAL PROTECTION IN IRELAND

Between 2022 and 2024, the number of applicants for international protection in Ireland rose from 13,645 to 18,435 (Eurostat, 2024). These figures exclude Beneficiaries of Temporary Protection from Ukraine, who fall under a separate legal framework (see Chapter 5). In 2024, 62 per cent of applicants were male, and 28 per cent were under the age of 18 (Murphy et al., 2025). Just over half of all applicants came from four main countries of origin: Nigeria (22%), Jordan (15%), Pakistan (8%), and Somalia (7%) (ibid.).

By the end of 2025, 32,921 people were living in International Protection Accommodation Services (IPAS) accommodation. Applicants either residing in IPAS-provided accommodation or remaining on a waiting list for placement may receive the Daily Expenses Allowance (DEA), set at €38.80 per week for adults and €29.80 for children. Applicants who have not yet been offered accommodation, or are still waiting to be placed, may receive a higher DEA rate of €113.80 per week.

Applicants for international protection may access the labour market once they have waited six months for an initial decision on their asylum application. They must apply for permission to work, which is valid for one year and renewable if their application is still pending. Those who work and earn more than €125 per week for 12 weeks or more may see their DEA reduced. Working applicants may also qualify for the Working Family Payment, depending on their household income.

A.II LIST OF COUNTRIES IN EACH REGION (WITH OBSERVATIONS IN THE OBSERVED YEARS)

Countries included in EU East: Bulgaria, Czech Republic, Estonia, Croatia, Latvia, Lithuania, Cyprus, Hungary, Malta, Poland, Romania, Slovak Republic.

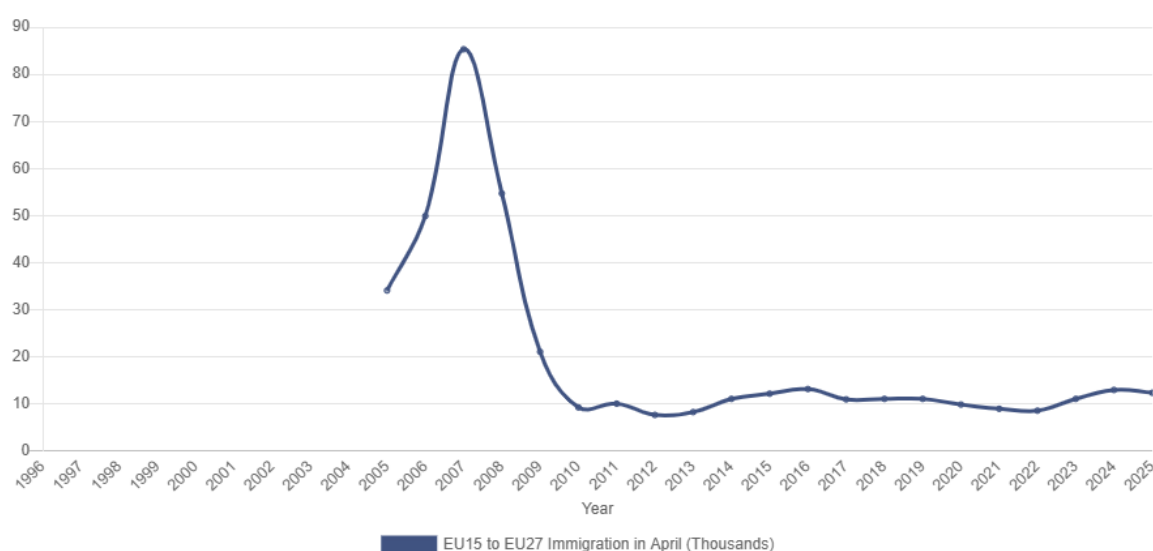
Countries included in EU West: Austria, Belgium, Denmark, Germany, Ireland, Greece, Spain, France, Luxembourg, Netherlands, Portugal, Finland, Sweden, United Kingdom, Switzerland, Iceland, Norway.

Countries included in Africa: North Africa (Algeria, Egypt, Libyan Arab Jamahiriya, Morocco, Sudan, Tunisia, Western Sahara); West Africa (Benin, Burkina Faso, Cape Verde, Côte d'Ivoire, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, Liberia, Mali, Mauritania, Niger, Nigeria, Saint Helena, Senegal, Sierra Leone, Togo); Other Africa.

Countries included in Asia: Near and Middle East (Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bahrain, Georgia, Iraq, Israel, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Occupied Palestinian Territory, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syrian Arab Republic, United Arab Emirates, Yemen); Other Asia.

Countries included in Other: Turkey, Other European Countries, United States, Canada, Central and South America, Australia and Oceania, Other.

FIGURE A.1 ESTIMATED IMMIGRATION FROM EU EAST (I.E. EU15 TO EU27), 2005–2025



August 26, 2025 11:00:00 UTC

Source: CSO (PEA24 – Estimated Immigration (Persons in April)).

TABLE A.1 WEIGHTED SUMMARY STATISTICS FOR EU EAST (AVERAGES)

Year →	2008	2009	2010	2013	2015	2018	2019	2020	2021	2024
Age	30 (6.3)	29 (6.7)	32 (8.0)	34 (8.1)	35 (9.0)	36 (8.1)	37 (9.0)	36 (9.1)	38 (9.0)	40 (9.8)
Gender										
Woman	44.0%	48.4%	54.8%	53.4%	52.2%	51.5%	54.3%	53.7%	57.6%	54.0%
Man	56.0%	51.6%	45.2%	46.6%	47.8%	48.5%	45.7%	46.3%	42.4%	46.0%
Children										
Number of children	0.9 (0.9)	0.8 (0.8)	0.9 (0.9)	1.0 (0.9)	1.0 (0.9)	1.2 (0.9)	1.1 (0.9)	1.1 (1.0)	1.3 (1.1)	1.2 (1.1)
No child	45.1%	42.4%	40.4%	34.9%	34.8%	24.9%	32.6%	31.3%	29.2%	31.3%
Children	54.9%	57.6%	59.6%	65.1%	65.2%	75.1%	67.4%	68.7%	70.8%	68.7%
Years of work	8 (6.9)	8 (7.0)	11 (7.8)	12 (7.7)	14 (8.)	13 (7.5)	15 (8.6)	15 (8.5)	16 (7.8)	18 (9.1)
Amongst workers										
Part-time work	.	25.1%	23.6%	29.7%	24.2%	23.0%	16.7%	18.8%	.	.
Full-time work	.	74.9%	76.4%	70.3%	75.8%	77.0%	83.3%	81.2%	.	.
Family benefits										
Does not receive	38.2%	38.4%	31.2%	27.3%	30.0%	24.4%	24.6%	27.4%	24.9%	29.4%
Receives	61.8%	61.6%	68.8%	72.7%	70.0%	75.6%	75.4%	72.6%	75.1%	70.6%
Unemployment benefits										
Does not receive	92.7%	81.9%	68.3%	66.7%	72.3%	75.5%	84.4%	82.9%	64.2%	90.4%
Receives	7.3%	18.1%	31.7%	33.3%	27.7%	24.5%	15.6%	17.1%	35.8%	
Unemployed										
No		80.9%	74.0%	79.5%	85.3%	.	90.2%	.	.	.
Yes	.	19.1%	26.0%	20.5%	14.7%	.	9.8%	.	.	.
Education										
Max sec. education	44.6%	41.8%	37.9%	44.8%	45.2%	36.6%	37.4%	37.7%	38.4%	48.6%
Post-secondary	55.4%	58.2%	62.1%	55.2%	54.8%	63.4%	62.6%	62.3%	61.6%	51.4%

Note: When less than 30 unweighted observations in a cell, shown as missing value ('.') in all categories for that variable and year.
Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

TABLE A.2 WEIGHTED SUMMARY STATISTICS FOR IRISH-BORN (AVERAGES)

Year →	2008	2009	2010	2013	2015	2018	2019	2020	2021	2024
Age	40 (14.2)	41 (14.2)	42 (13.9)	42 (13.9)	42 (13.9)	42 (13.9)	42 (14.0)	42 (13.6)	41 (13.7)	42 (13.9)
Gender										
Woman	49.1%	49.7%	49.6%	49.9%	49.8%	49.6%	50.4%	50.0%	50.2%	50.0%
Man	50.9%	50.3%	50.4%	50.1%	50.2%	50.4%	49.6%	50.0%	49.8%	50.0%
Children										
Number of children	0.9 (1.1)	0.8 (1.1)	0.8 (1.1)	0.8 (1.1)	0.8 (1.1)	0.8 (1.1)	0.8 (1.1)	0.8 (1.1)	0.7 (1.1)	0.7 (1.0)
No child	53.1%	52.8%	53.4%	53.9%	53.3%	53.4%	54.6%	57.8%	58.0%	59.5%
Children	46.9%	47.2%	46.6%	46.1%	46.7%	46.6%	45.4%	42.2%	42.0%	40.5%
Years of work	19 (12.7)	20 (12.8)	20 (12.5)	21 (12.4)	21 (12.6)	21 (12.7)	21 (12.7)	22 (12.4)	22 (12.3)	23 (12.1)
Amongst workers										
Part-time work	25.3%	28.0%	29.0%	28.6%	27.4%	23.5%	24.4%	19.0%	17.0%	17.5%
Full-time work	74.7%	72.0%	71.0%	71.4%	72.6%	76.5%	75.6%	81.0%	83.0%	82.5%
Family benefits										
Does not receive	42.2%	42.7%	44.4%	44.0%	44.9%	44.1%	44.8%	50.0%	49.8%	51.9%
Receives	57.8%	57.3%	55.6%	56.0%	55.1%	55.9%	55.2%	50.0%	50.2%	48.1%
Unemployment benefits										
Does not receive	86.1%	83.3%	80.2%	77.6%	81.5%	86.4%	85.6%	87.6%	72.6%	90.9%
Receives	13.9%	16.7%	19.8%	22.4%	18.5%	13.6%	14.4%	12.4%	27.4%	9.1%
Unemployed										
No	88.3%	83.9%	81.2%	81.0%	87.5%	93.0%	92.0%	92.4%	90.3%	95.3%
Yes	11.7%	16.1%	18.8%	19.0%	12.5%	7.0%	8.0%	7.6%	9.7%	4.7%
Education										
Max sec. education	64.4%	63.7%	60.5%	53.8%	51.6%	45.3%	45.7%	38.9%	42.7%	40.9%
Post-secondary	35.6%	36.3%	39.5%	46.2%	48.4%	54.7%	54.3%	61.1%	57.3%	59.1%

Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

TABLE A.3 GELBACH DECOMPOSITION FOR NON-CONTRIBUTORY FAMILY AND CHILDREN-RELATED ALLOWANCES FOR EU EAST VS. IRISH-BORN (2014–2024, POOLED)

Restricted regression:						
FAM_NCMT	Coefficient	Std. err.	[95% conf.	interval]	Mediator	Share of difference in coefficient
Eastern vs. IE	0.08	0.02	0.05	0.11	Year	1%
_cons	0.17	0.00	0.16	0.18	Years of work	40%
					Number of children	-17%
					Male	-2%
Unrestricted regression:					Full-time work	-5%
FAM_NCMT	Coefficient	Std. err.	[95% conf.	interval]	Parents	-1%
					Education	52%
Eastern vs.IE	0.05	0.02	0.02	0.08	Age	32%
Year	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00		
Years of work	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00		
Number of children	0.02	0.00	0.01	0.03		
Male	0.02	0.01	0.01	0.04		
Full-time Work	-0.18	0.01	-0.20	-0.16		
Parents	0.32	0.02	0.28	0.36		
Education	-0.18	0.01	-0.20	-0.16		
Age	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00		
_cons	-1.08	2.42	-5.83	3.67		

Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

Note: FAM_NCMT stands for non-contributory means-tested family allowances.

TABLE A.4 GELBACH DECOMPOSITION FOR UNEMPLOYMENT BENEFITS FOR EU EAST VS. IRISH-BORN (2014–2024, POOLED)

Restricted regression:						
Unemployment	Coefficient	Std. err.	[95% conf.	interval]	Mediator	Share of difference in coefficient
Eastern vs. IE	0.04	0.01	0.02	0.06	Year	2%
_cons	0.13	0.00	0.13	0.14	Years of work	125%
					Number of children	-17%
					Male	-4%
Unrestricted regression:						
					Full-time work	-40%
Unemployment	Coefficient	Std. err.	[95% conf.	interval]		5%
					Education	24%
Eastern vs. IE	0.03	0.01	0.01	0.05	Age	6%
Year	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00		
Years of work	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00		
Number of children	-0.01	0.00	-0.02	0.00		
Male	0.04	0.01	0.03	0.05		
Full-time work	-0.18	0.01	-0.19	-0.16		
Parents	0.00	0.01	-0.01	0.02		
Education	-0.08	0.01	-0.09	-0.07		
Age	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00		
_cons	-2.60	1.43	-5.39	0.19		

Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

TABLE A.5 MARGINAL EFFECTS, RECIPIENTS OF CONTRIBUTORY NON-MEANS-TESTED FAMILY ALLOWANCES

Year →	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
Irish-born	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base
UK	-0.02	-0.03***	-0.02*	-0.02	-0.01	-0.02	-0.01	-0.05***	-0.07***	-0.02	-0.02
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.02)
EU West	-0.03**	-0.01	0.01	-0.05***	0.02	-0.00	0.02	-0.05***	-0.05**	0.01	0.02
	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.04)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)
EU East	-0.00	-0.03***	-0.00	-0.04***	-0.02**	-0.02**	0.01	-0.04***	-0.05***	0.00	-0.03**
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.01)
Asia	0.04	-0.01	-0.03**	-0.03**	-0.05***	-0.02	-0.01	-0.02	-0.05**	-0.01	-0.01
	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)
Africa	0.00	-0.03	-0.03***	-0.04**	-0.01	0.00	-0.04***	0.00	-0.06***	-0.04**	-0.02
	(.)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(.)	(0.01)	(.)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)
Other	-0.00	0.00	-0.03*	-0.01	-0.01	-0.03	-0.04***	-0.05***	-0.04	-0.01	-0.01
	(0.02)	(.)	(0.01)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)
Covariates	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
Observat°	6,306	6,207	6,019	5,778	5,069	4,653	4,932	5,521	5,144	4,660	5,367

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

TABLE A.6 MARGINAL EFFECTS, RECIPIENTS OF NON-CONTRIBUTORY MEANS-TESTED FAMILY ALLOWANCES

Year →	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
Irish-born	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base
UK	0.02	0.03	0.07***	0.08***	0.06**	-0.01	0.03	-0.02	-0.00	0.05	-0.01
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)
EU West	-0.12***	-0.13***	-0.08***	-0.09**	-0.06**	-0.07**	0.02	-0.06***	0.01	-0.05	-0.05
	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.04)	(0.02)	(0.08)	(0.04)	(0.03)
EU East	0.06***	0.01	0.02	-0.03	0.01	0.03	0.08***	0.02	0.14***	0.05	0.04
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.05)	(0.04)	(0.03)
Asia	-0.01	0.08*	0.04	0.02	0.08*	-0.02	-0.03	-0.01	-0.07**	-0.10***	-0.05**
	(0.04)	(0.05)	(0.05)	(0.04)	(0.04)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.04)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)
Africa	0.15**	0.08*	0.09*	0.19***	0.13**	0.05	0.16***	0.01	0.04	0.11*	0.08*
	(0.06)	(0.05)	(0.05)	(0.06)	(0.06)	(0.05)	(0.05)	(0.04)	(0.08)	(0.06)	(0.05)
Other	-0.06	0.02	-0.02	-0.05	-0.13***	-0.12***	-0.04	-0.07**	-0.04	0.02	0.02
	(0.04)	(0.05)	(0.05)	(0.03)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)
Covariates	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
Observat°	6,414	6,415	6,029	5,783	5,148	4,932	4,942	5,694	5,444	4,726	5,553

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

TABLE A.7 MARGINAL EFFECTS, RECIPIENTS OF CONTRIBUTORY NON-MEANS-TESTED UNEMPLOYMENT BENEFITS

Year →	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
Irish-born	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base
UK	-0.02**	-0.01	-0.03***	-0.01	-0.01	-0.00	0.02	0.02	-0.01	-0.02	0.02
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)
EU West	-0.01	0.00	-0.02	-0.02	0.02	0.07*	0.07*	0.07*	-0.02	-0.05***	0.00
	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.04)	(0.04)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.02)
EU East	0.04**	0.05***	0.04*	0.04*	0.02	0.01	0.04**	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.02
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)
Asia	-0.06***	-0.03**	-0.04***	-0.02	-0.02	-0.04***	-0.03***	-0.03	0.00	-0.00	-0.01
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(.)	(0.03)	(0.02)
Africa	0.04	-0.00	-0.03*	-0.03**	-0.00	-0.01	-0.02	0.00	0.00	0.00	-0.02
	(0.05)	(0.03)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(.)	(.)	(0.02)
Other	-0.02	-0.01	-0.03***	0.00	-0.01	-0.01	0.04	0.02	-0.02	-0.03*	-0.02
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(.)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.01)
Covariates	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
Observat°	6,404	6,415	5,993	5,665	5,026	4,503	4,932	5,572	5,209	4,544	5,388

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

TABLE A.8 MARGINAL EFFECTS, RECIPIENTS OF NON-CONTRIBUTORY MEANS-TESTED UNEMPLOYMENT BENEFITS

Year →	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
Irish-born	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base	Base
UK	0.04*	0.05**	0.02	0.04*	0.04*	-0.00	-0.01	-0.01	0.02	-0.00	-0.00
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.01)
EU West	-0.07***	-0.08***	-0.03	-0.03	-0.04	-0.04	-0.01	0.00	0.07	0.04	0.05
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.07)	(0.04)	(0.07)
EU East	0.04*	0.03	0.03	0.00	0.07**	0.03	0.02	0.01	0.00	0.00	-0.01
	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.01)
Asia	-0.04	0.02	-0.04	-0.01	-0.02	-0.02	-0.04*	-0.04***	-0.03**	0.00	0.00
	(0.03)	(0.04)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.04)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.02)	(0.02)
Africa	0.02	-0.02	0.13**	0.04	0.00	0.01	0.05	-0.01	-0.01	0.10*	0.07
	(0.05)	(0.04)	(0.06)	(0.05)	(0.04)	(0.04)	(0.05)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.05)	(0.05)
Other	-0.06**	-0.01	-0.04	-0.04	-0.06**	-0.03	-0.01	-0.01	-0.00	0.06*	0.03
	(0.03)	(0.04)	(0.04)	(0.04)	(0.02)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.04)	(0.03)
Covariates	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
Observat°	6,407	6,417	6,031	5,783	5,148	4,932	4,942	5,700	5,440	4,722	5,470

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

TABLE A.9 MARGINAL EFFECTS, RECIPIENTS OF UNEMPLOYMENT BENEFITS AMONGST THE UNEMPLOYED (2014–2024, POOLED)

	Unemployment	Contributory	Non-contributory
Irish-born	Base	Base	Base
UK	0	0	0
	(.)	(.)	(.)
EU West	0	0	0
	(.)	(.)	(.)
EU East	-0.02	0.04	0
	-0.04	-0.03	(.)
Asia	-0.19***	0	0
	-0.05	(.)	(.)
Africa	0	0	0
	(.)	(.)	(.)
Other	0	0	0
	(.)	(.)	(.)
Covariates	YES	YES	YES
Observat°	3,686	3,474	3,681

Note: Standard errors in parentheses. * 0.1 ** 0.05 *** 0.01: significant difference with Irish-born.

Source: CSO (Survey on Income and Living Conditions).

TABLE A.10 CLASSIFICATION OF SOCIAL WELFARE PAYMENTS IN SILC

Social Welfare Payments
Unemployment benefits
Contributory non-means-tested: Jobseeker's Benefit; statutory redundancy payment to <66 years old; Insolvency Payment; Jobseeker's Benefit for self-employed
Non-contributory means-tested: Farm Assist; Jobseeker's Allowance; Back to Work Allowance; Back to Work Family Dividend; Back to Work Enterprise Allowance; Back to Education Allowance; Pre-Retirement Allowance; annual value of education grant(s) for training or vocational allowance; DSP National Internship payments; Part-Time Job Incentive
Non-contributory non-means-tested: Community Employment scheme income from PMOD; Pandemic Unemployment Payment
Sickness benefits
Contributory non-means-tested: Occupational Injuries Benefit; Illness Benefit (DB/IB) aged <66; other DSP payments with codes: IDB/OIDB/LTDB/DBPD/ IDPD, aged <66
Disability benefits
Contributory non-means-tested: Constant Attendance Allowance; Disablement Benefit aged <66; Disablement Benefit Gratuities aged <66; other DSP codes: IDP/DPSD, aged <66; Invalidity Pension aged <66; Partial Capacity Benefit aged <66
Non-contributory means-tested: Disability Allowance aged <66; Blind Person's Pension aged <66
Family/children-related allowances
Contributory means-tested: Working Family Payment
Contributory non-means-tested: Maternity Benefit; Adoptive Parent Benefit; Carer's Benefit; Deserted Wife's Benefit; Paternity Benefit; Contributory Guardian's Payment; Parent's Benefit; Health and Safety Benefit
Non-contributory means-tested: Back to School Clothing and Footwear Allowance; Basic Supplementary Welfare Allowance; Carer's Allowance; One-Parent Family Payment; Deserted Wife's Allowance; Diet Supplement; Non-Contributory Guardian's Payment
Non-contributory non-means-tested: Child Benefit; Carer's Support Grant; Domiciliary Care Allowance



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